

Commercial Pilot

Flight Lesson Guide

An original flight teaching companion organized in the current publisher lesson sequence. Each flight begins with a complete operating plan, then assigns a realistic exercise budget and observable results. Ground entries point to the corresponding preparation; the detailed teaching is in the flight/device lessons. Source targets remain visible. Assessment and exercise selections must be adapted to the actual learner, aircraft, weather, and available facilities.

Sporty's Academy Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026; original Part 61 teaching layer. The source is a Part 141 TCO, not a Part 61 minimum-hour prescription.

Use this guide

Read the full teaching guide before flight. Use the compact checklist to sequence the flight. Minutes are pacing targets; repeat, stop, or defer an exercise when proficiency, conditions, or available time require it. Checkmarks indicate items covered, not a proficiency endorsement.

Aircraft values come from the applicable POH/AFM and approved checklist. Brief the aircraft-specific speeds, configurations, limitations, and any simulation method before conducting a maneuver.

Entry and preparation

- Confirm prerequisite certificates, privileges, medical eligibility where required, recency, and aircraft authorization.
- Use the applicable POH/AFM, current charts, approved equipment manuals, and current FAA standards.
- Reconcile the student's logbook against current Part 61 separately; completing these timed lessons does not establish certificate eligibility.
- Device time is not aircraft flight time. Credit only approved training/tasks under the device authorization and applicable regulation.

Sources and alignment

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

Current FAA Airman Certification Standards - Current FAA linked standard

Part 61 experience requirements - Verified 2026-10-10

Lesson index

Cross-country experience and decisions

- 1 · Preparation: Cross-Country Flight Planning, Federal Aviation Regulations, National Airspace System · Ground preparation
- 2 · Day cross-country and instrument practice · 210 min dual
- 3 · Night cross-country and instrument practice · 210 min dual
- 4 · Solo cross-country to a towered airport · 120 min solo
- 5 · PIC route practice and crew coordination · 132 min pic
- 6 · Extended PIC navigation · 240 min pic
- 7 · Solo night tower patterns · 78 min solo
- 8 · PIC route and fuel discipline · 240 min pic
- 9 · Solo night proficiency · 78 min solo
- 10 · Long solo cross-country · 420 min solo
- 11 · Solo night experience consolidation · 78 min solo
- 12 · VFR diversion and lost-position review · 90 min dual
- 13 · Stage I navigation assessment · 120 min check

Complex operational environments

- 14 · Preparation: Use of the Airman Certification Standards, Aircraft Equipment and Operational Requirements & L... · Ground preparation
- 15 · Commercial precision baseline · 90 min dual
- 16 · Independent precision practice · 78 min pic
- 17 · Preparation: National Airspace System, Procurement & Use of Aviation Weather, Reports & Forecasts · Ground preparation
- 18 · Dual high traffic cross-country · 240 min dual
- 19 · Preparation: Garmin G1000, Line Replaceable Units, Primary Flight Display (PFD) · Ground preparation
- 20 · Glass cockpit VFR workflow · 96 min device
- 21 · Independent handling consolidation · 78 min pic
- 22 · Glass cockpit IFR workflow · 96 min device
- 23 · High traffic PIC destination · 420 min pic
- 24 · Glass cockpit restrictions and failures · 96 min device
- 25 · Performance-limited PIC destination · 360 min pic
- 26 · Dual IFR route and monitoring duties · 240 min dual

- 27 · PIC multi-airport IFR route · 180 min pic
- 28 · Glass cockpit automation and abnormal work · 120 min device
- 29 · PIC IFR route refinement · 180 min pic
- 30 · Preparation: Required Documents for International Flights, International & Canadian / Bahamian Flight Plans... · Ground preparation
- 31 · International PIC operation · 240 min pic
- 32 · Stage II operational decisions assessment · 120 min check

Complex, TAA, and high-performance operations

- 33 · Preparation: Pilot Qualifications for Complex and High-Performance Aircraft, Airworthiness Requirements, Pe... · Ground preparation
- 34 · Complex or TAA device familiarization · 90 min device
- 35 · Complex or TAA device abnormal work · 78 min device
- 36 · Complex or TAA aircraft introduction · 90 min dual
- 37 · Configuration, slow flight, and emergencies · 90 min dual
- 38 · Complex or TAA handling refinement · 108 min dual
- 39 · High-performance pattern introduction · 78 min dual
- 40 · High-performance proficiency · 78 min dual
- 41 · Complex or TAA device approaches · 78 min device
- 42 · Complex or TAA aircraft approaches · 120 min dual
- 43 · Complex or TAA PIC readiness · 102 min dual
- 44 · Stage III aircraft assessment · 90 min check

Commercial maneuvers and final readiness

- 45 · Preparation: Four Forces of Flight (Lift, Drag, Weight, Thrust), Four Fundamentals of Flight (Straight & Le... · Ground preparation
- 46 · Chandelles and steep spirals · 78 min dual
- 47 · Lazy eights and energy refinement · 78 min dual
- 48 · Preparation: Eights on Pylons, Determining Wind Direction & Speed, Effect of Wind · Ground preparation
- 49 · Pylons and accuracy landing introduction · 78 min dual
- 50 · Performance maneuver integration · 78 min dual
- 51 · Independent maneuver and landing practice · 78 min pic
- 52 · Preparation: Aerodynamic Forces, Gyroscopic Forces, Aircraft Certification · Ground preparation
- 53 · Advanced stall-risk recognition · 90 min dual
- 54 · Stall-risk recovery proficiency · 90 min dual

- 55 · Precision and stall-risk review · 78 min dual
- 56 · Ground references and landing refinement · 78 min dual
- 57 · Preparation: Commercial Pilot Privileges & Limitations, Basic Aerodynamics, Recognition of Critical Weather... · Ground preparation
- 58 · Integrated commercial review · 78 min dual
- 59 · Independent commercial rehearsal · 78 min pic
- 60 · Correction of integrated flight errors · 78 min dual
- 61 · VFR route and diversion consolidation · 108 min dual
- 62 · Preparation: Pilot Qualifications, Airworthiness Requirements, National Airspace System · Ground preparation
- 63 · Independent precision consolidation · 78 min pic
- 64 · Independent landing and maneuver refinement · 78 min pic
- 65 · Instructor-guided readiness corrections · 78 min dual
- 66 · Airport technique and abnormal decisions · 90 min dual
- 67 · Preparation: Pilot Qualifications, Commercial Pilot Privileges & Limitations, Airworthiness Requirements · Ground preparation
- 67a · Independent readiness assessment · 108 min check
- 68 · Final proficiency review · 90 min dual
- 69 · End-of-course assessment · 108 min check

Cross-country experience and decisions

Refine day/night route management and independent experience. Verify Part 61 experience separately from source course totals.

Lesson 1 · Preparation: Cross-Country Flight Planning, Federal Aviation Regulations, National Airspace System

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 2 · Day cross-country and instrument practice

[Return to lesson index](#)

210 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-137 Air 08-132	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
137-197 Air 132-192	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
197-207 Air 192-202	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
207-210 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 2

Practice day cross-country and instrument practice. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 60-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.
- Verify the source day/night route and current §61.129(a)(3): the applicable 2-hour training cross-country must meet the more-than-100-NM straight-line condition. Allocate the source 60-minute instrument subset only with the proper instruction/lookout arrangement.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 124 minutes

Teach / coach: Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 60 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 60 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Flow Checks. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PIC Brief. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Division of Responsibilities. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Sterile Cockpit. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Forward Slip to Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 2 - source page 23 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 3 · Night cross-country and instrument practice

[Return to lesson index](#)

210 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-117 Air 08-112	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
117-137 Air 112-132	[] Night orientation and tower pattern work	Fly a conservative night route or pattern as planned, positively identify the runway, comply with tower instructions, and make stabilized approaches and...
137-197 Air 132-192	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
197-207 Air 192-202	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
207-210 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 3

Practice night cross-country and instrument practice. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 60-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Maintains orientation, uses lighting deliberately, and chooses go-around or termination before visual illusion or fatigue affects control.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.
- Verify the source day/night route and current §61.129(a)(3): the applicable 2-hour training cross-country must meet the more-than-100-NM straight-line condition. Allocate the source 60-minute instrument subset only with the proper instruction/lookout arrangement.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 104 minutes

Teach / coach: Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Night orientation and tower pattern work · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief night equipment, vision limitations, lighting identification, taxi hotspots, terrain, forced-landing options, and fatigue. Before an independent flight agree on airport/tower availability, weather, counts, fuel, and stop conditions; confirm privileges and any needed authorizations.

Student exercise: Fly a conservative night route or pattern as planned, positively identify the runway, comply with tower instructions, and make stabilized approaches and full-stop landings. After each landing reassess fatigue, weather, fuel, and the remaining safe training budget.

Practice: Plan a defensible number of full-stop patterns based on traffic and aircraft; extend or repeat flights when regulatory counts/hours remain unmet.

Look for: Maintains orientation, uses lighting deliberately, and chooses go-around or termination before visual illusion or fatigue affects control.

Watch / correct: Black-hole approach cues - use a stabilized approach and available visual/electronic guidance.

Watch / correct: Counts drive rushed circuits - accept sequencing delays or finish the remaining counts another flight.

Stop / transition: End the flight for fatigue, deteriorating visibility, lighting/tower changes affecting the plan, or unstable approaches.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Night orientation and tower pattern work; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop - 60 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 60 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision - 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
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- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Division of Responsibilities. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Sterile Cockpit. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
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- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 3 - source page 24 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 4 · Solo cross-country to a towered airport

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min solo | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-88 Air 08-83	[] VFR route management and diversion	Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
88-107 Air 83-102	[] High traffic and complex airport operations	Independently: Obtain required clearances, monitor the traffic/ATC picture, verify runway assignments aloud, and comply with speed/route instructions within...
107-117 Air 102-112	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
117-120 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 4

Practice solo cross-country to a towered airport. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Uses explicit clearances, avoids fixation and runway confusion, and asks for time before capacity is exceeded.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 75 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

High traffic and complex airport operations · 19 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief current airport diagrams, hotspots, arrival routes, frequencies, clearances, wake turbulence, and escape options. Dual sessions model concise communication and workload allocation; independent sessions require the pilot to explain a plan for an amended clearance. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Obtain required clearances, monitor the traffic/ATC picture, verify runway assignments aloud, and comply with speed/route instructions within aircraft limits. Request clarification, delay, vectors, or go-around whenever the clearance or landing picture is unsafe.

Practice: One high workload arrival/departure, one amended instruction, and a runway-assignment cross-check.

Look for: Uses explicit clearances, avoids fixation and runway confusion, and asks for time before capacity is exceeded.

Watch / correct: Following traffic without own clearance - verify the actual clearance and runway.

Watch / correct: ATC request exceeds capability - respond unable and propose a safe alternative.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the planned destination when traffic, winds, runway, or workload prevents safe compliance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; High traffic and complex airport operations; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Tower Controlled Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Physiological Aspects of Night Flying. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 4 - source page 25 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 5 · PIC route practice and crew coordination

[Return to lesson index](#)

132 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-119 Air 08-114	[] VFR route management and diversion	Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
119-129 Air 114-124	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
129-132 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 5

Practice pic route practice and crew coordination. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 106 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Flow Checks. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PIC Brief. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Division of Responsibilities. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Sterile Cockpit. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Tower Controlled Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Non-towered Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 5 - source page 26 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 6 · Extended PIC navigation

[Return to lesson index](#)

240 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-227 Air 08-222	[] VFR route management and diversion	Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
227-237 Air 222-232	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
237-240 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 6

Practice extended pic navigation. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 214 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Flow Checks. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PIC Brief. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Division of Responsibilities. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Sterile Cockpit. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Tower Controlled Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Non-towered Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 6 - source page 27 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 7 · Solo night tower patterns

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min solo | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-39 Air 08-34	[] Night orientation and tower pattern work	Independently: Fly a conservative night route or pattern as planned, positively identify the runway, comply with tower instructions, and make stabilized...
39-65 Air 34-60	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 7

Practice solo night tower patterns. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Maintains orientation, uses lighting deliberately, and chooses go-around or termination before visual illusion or fatigue affects control.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Night orientation and tower pattern work · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief night equipment, vision limitations, lighting identification, taxi hotspots, terrain, forced-landing options, and fatigue. Before an independent flight agree on airport/tower availability, weather, counts, fuel, and stop conditions; confirm privileges and any needed authorizations. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly a conservative night route or pattern as planned, positively identify the runway, comply with tower instructions, and make stabilized approaches and full-stop landings. After each landing reassess fatigue, weather, fuel, and the remaining safe training budget.

Practice: Plan a defensible number of full-stop patterns based on traffic and aircraft; extend or repeat flights when regulatory counts/hours remain unmet.

Look for: Maintains orientation, uses lighting deliberately, and chooses go-around or termination before visual illusion or fatigue affects control.

Watch / correct: Black-hole approach cues - use a stabilized approach and available visual/electronic guidance.

Watch / correct: Counts drive rushed circuits - accept sequencing delays or finish the remaining counts another flight.

Stop / transition: End the flight for fatigue, deteriorating visibility, lighting/tower changes affecting the plan, or unstable approaches.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Night orientation and tower pattern work; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.

- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.

- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief - 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Tower Controlled Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Reconcile the required night hours and towered takeoff/landing counts across the actual flights. A 78-minute source target cannot guarantee required counts in traffic; extend or repeat when needed.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 7 - source page 28 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 8 · PIC route and fuel discipline

[Return to lesson index](#)

240 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-227 Air 08-222	[] VFR route management and diversion	Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
227-237 Air 222-232	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
237-240 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 8

Practice pic route and fuel discipline. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 214 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Flow Checks. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PIC Brief. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Division of Responsibilities. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Sterile Cockpit. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Tower Controlled Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Non-towered Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 8 - source page 29 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 9 · Solo night proficiency

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min solo | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-39 Air 08-34	[] Night orientation and tower pattern work	Independently: Fly a conservative night route or pattern as planned, positively identify the runway, comply with tower instructions, and make stabilized...
39-65 Air 34-60	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 9

Practice solo night proficiency. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Maintains orientation, uses lighting deliberately, and chooses go-around or termination before visual illusion or fatigue affects control.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Night orientation and tower pattern work · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief night equipment, vision limitations, lighting identification, taxi hotspots, terrain, forced-landing options, and fatigue. Before an independent flight agree on airport/tower availability, weather, counts, fuel, and stop conditions; confirm privileges and any needed authorizations. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly a conservative night route or pattern as planned, positively identify the runway, comply with tower instructions, and make stabilized approaches and full-stop landings. After each landing reassess fatigue, weather, fuel, and the remaining safe training budget.

Practice: Plan a defensible number of full-stop patterns based on traffic and aircraft; extend or repeat flights when regulatory counts/hours remain unmet.

Look for: Maintains orientation, uses lighting deliberately, and chooses go-around or termination before visual illusion or fatigue affects control.

Watch / correct: Black-hole approach cues - use a stabilized approach and available visual/electronic guidance.

Watch / correct: Counts drive rushed circuits - accept sequencing delays or finish the remaining counts another flight.

Stop / transition: End the flight for fatigue, deteriorating visibility, lighting/tower changes affecting the plan, or unstable approaches.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Night orientation and tower pattern work; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.

- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.

- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief - 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Tower Controlled Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Reconcile the required night hours and towered takeoff/landing counts across the actual flights. A 78-minute source target cannot guarantee required counts in traffic; extend or repeat when needed.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 9 - source page 30 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 10 · Long solo cross-country

[Return to lesson index](#)

420 min solo | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-133 Air 08-128	[] Cross-country leg 1: route and fuel checks	Fly planned leg 1 to its selected landing point.
133-141 Air 128-136	[] Intermediate airport 1: landing	Identify the airport/runway, obtain necessary arrival information or clearance, configure using the approved procedure, land from a stabilized approach or go...
141-143 Ground	[] Intermediate airport 1: taxi and stop	Taxi, secure as needed, and reassess fuel, weather, performance and personal readiness before continuing.
143-145 Ground	[] Intermediate airport 1: departure taxi	Restart if needed, perform the approved checklist and taxi flow, verify clearances/runway, and complete required departure checks.
145-150 Air 136-141	[] Intermediate airport 1: takeoff	Verify runway and clearance, perform the approved takeoff/climb, complete configuration checks and establish the next leg.
150-270 Air 141-261	[] Cross-country leg 2: route and fuel checks	Fly planned leg 2 to its selected landing point.
270-278 Air 261-269	[] Intermediate airport 2: landing	Identify the airport/runway, obtain necessary arrival information or clearance, configure using the approved procedure, land from a stabilized approach or go...
278-280 Ground	[] Intermediate airport 2: taxi and stop	Taxi, secure as needed, and reassess fuel, weather, performance and personal readiness before continuing.
280-282 Ground	[] Intermediate airport 2: departure taxi	Restart if needed, perform the approved checklist and taxi flow, verify clearances/runway, and complete required departure checks.
282-287 Air 269-274	[] Intermediate airport 2: takeoff	Verify runway and clearance, perform the approved takeoff/climb, complete configuration checks and establish the next leg.
287-407 Air 274-394	[] Cross-country leg 3: route and fuel checks	Fly planned leg 3 to its selected landing point.
407-417 Air 394-404	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
417-420 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 10

Practice long solo cross-country. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.
- Verify current §61.129(a)(4) and the actual experience route: at least 300 NM total, landings at three points, and the required 250-NM straight-line distance from the original departure point (Hawaii exception only when applicable). Source target 420 minutes is a planning estimate; distance, safe fuel stops, weather and actual completion govern.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Cross-country leg 1: route and fuel checks · 120 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch verify the independent route, landing points, actual Part 61 distance conditions, aircraft range, fuel stops, weather and overdue plan. Agree on stop/return gates. The pilot makes each in-flight and continuation decision independently.

Student exercise: Fly planned leg 1 to its selected landing point. Cross-check route, terrain/airspace, position, groundspeed, fuel and weather at the briefed checkpoints; update the next alternate/continuation decision. Verify actual distance against the qualifying route before continuing.

Practice: Check position, ETA and fuel at each planned checkpoint; complete this leg only while continuation remains safe.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Intermediate airport 1: landing · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the selected runway, performance, traffic and alternate options. The pilot must make the actual safe landing/go-around choice independently.

Student exercise: Identify the airport/runway, obtain necessary arrival information or clearance, configure using the approved procedure, land from a stabilized approach or go around, and clear the runway.

Practice: One planned intermediate arrival and landing.

Look for: Safe arrival, correct landing point, and an independent continuation decision.

Watch / correct: Pressing on to preserve distance - divert or stop when conditions require.

Stop / transition: Go around or divert when a safe landing is unavailable.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Intermediate airport 1: taxi and stop · 2 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch agree on fuel/rest stops, weather updates and an overdue plan; review the planned checklist flow.

Student exercise: Taxi, secure as needed, and reassess fuel, weather, performance and personal readiness before continuing. Engine-off fuel/rest time is separate from this flight movement clock.

Practice: One deliberate continuation check at this airport.

Look for: No continuation with unresolved fuel, weather, performance or readiness issues.

Watch / correct: Schedule pressure - stop and revise the route.

Stop / transition: Stop the trip if continuation gates are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Intermediate airport 1: departure taxi · 2 minutes

Teach / coach: Review the departure checklist and runway/hotspot plan before dispatch; the pilot executes it independently.

Student exercise: Restart if needed, perform the approved checklist and taxi flow, verify clearances/runway, and complete required departure checks.

Practice: One complete departure flow.

Look for: Correct runway and configuration before takeoff.

Watch / correct: Rushed restart - complete checks before movement or takeoff.

Stop / transition: Stop for an unresolved abnormality or uncertain clearance.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Intermediate airport 1: takeoff · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch verify performance, departure route and weather for each planned continuation.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, perform the approved takeoff/climb, complete configuration checks and establish the next leg.

Practice: One safe departure onto the next planned course.

Look for: Meets aircraft limitations and maintains a safe route/terrain picture.

Watch / correct: Missed performance reassessment - recompute before departure.

Stop / transition: Abort or return using actual aircraft procedures and conditions.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Cross-country leg 2: route and fuel checks · 120 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch verify the independent route, landing points, actual Part 61 distance conditions, aircraft range, fuel stops, weather and overdue plan. Agree on stop/return gates. The pilot makes each in-flight and continuation decision independently.

Student exercise: Fly planned leg 2 to its selected landing point. Cross-check route, terrain/airspace, position, groundspeed, fuel and weather at the briefed checkpoints; update the next alternate/continuation decision.

Verify actual distance against the qualifying route before continuing.

Practice: Check position, ETA and fuel at each planned checkpoint; complete this leg only while continuation remains safe.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Intermediate airport 2: landing · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the selected runway, performance, traffic and alternate options. The pilot must make the actual safe landing/go-around choice independently.

Student exercise: Identify the airport/runway, obtain necessary arrival information or clearance, configure using the approved procedure, land from a stabilized approach or go around, and clear the runway.

Practice: One planned intermediate arrival and landing.

Look for: Safe arrival, correct landing point, and an independent continuation decision.

Watch / correct: Pressing on to preserve distance - divert or stop when conditions require.

Stop / transition: Go around or divert when a safe landing is unavailable.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Intermediate airport 2: taxi and stop · 2 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch agree on fuel/rest stops, weather updates and an overdue plan; review the planned checklist flow.

Student exercise: Taxi, secure as needed, and reassess fuel, weather, performance and personal readiness before continuing. Engine-off fuel/rest time is separate from this flight movement clock.

Practice: One deliberate continuation check at this airport.

Look for: No continuation with unresolved fuel, weather, performance or readiness issues.

Watch / correct: Schedule pressure - stop and revise the route.

Stop / transition: Stop the trip if continuation gates are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Intermediate airport 2: departure taxi · 2 minutes

Teach / coach: Review the departure checklist and runway/hotspot plan before dispatch; the pilot executes it independently.

Student exercise: Restart if needed, perform the approved checklist and taxi flow, verify clearances/runway, and complete required departure checks.

Practice: One complete departure flow.

Look for: Correct runway and configuration before takeoff.

Watch / correct: Rushed restart - complete checks before movement or takeoff.

Stop / transition: Stop for an unresolved abnormality or uncertain clearance.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Intermediate airport 2: takeoff · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch verify performance, departure route and weather for each planned continuation.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, perform the approved takeoff/climb, complete configuration checks and establish the next leg.

Practice: One safe departure onto the next planned course.

Look for: Meets aircraft limitations and maintains a safe route/terrain picture.

Watch / correct: Missed performance reassessment - recompute before departure.

Stop / transition: Abort or return using actual aircraft procedures and conditions.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Cross-country leg 3: route and fuel checks · 120 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch verify the independent route, landing points, actual Part 61 distance conditions, aircraft range, fuel stops, weather and overdue plan. Agree on stop/return gates. The pilot makes each in-flight and continuation decision independently.

Student exercise: Fly planned leg 3 to its selected landing point. Cross-check route, terrain/airspace, position, groundspeed, fuel and weather at the briefed checkpoints; update the next alternate/continuation decision. Verify actual distance against the qualifying route before continuing.

Practice: Check position, ETA and fuel at each planned checkpoint; complete this leg only while continuation remains safe.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Flow Checks. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Tower Controlled Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Non-towered Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 10 - source page 31 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 11 · Solo night experience consolidation

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min solo | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-39 Air 08-34	[] Night orientation and tower pattern work	Independently: Fly a conservative night route or pattern as planned, positively identify the runway, comply with tower instructions, and make stabilized...
39-65 Air 34-60	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 11

Practice solo night experience consolidation. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Maintains orientation, uses lighting deliberately, and chooses go-around or termination before visual illusion or fatigue affects control.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Night orientation and tower pattern work · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief night equipment, vision limitations, lighting identification, taxi hotspots, terrain, forced-landing options, and fatigue. Before an independent flight agree on airport/tower availability, weather, counts, fuel, and stop conditions; confirm privileges and any needed authorizations. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly a conservative night route or pattern as planned, positively identify the runway, comply with tower instructions, and make stabilized approaches and full-stop landings. After each landing reassess fatigue, weather, fuel, and the remaining safe training budget.

Practice: Plan a defensible number of full-stop patterns based on traffic and aircraft; extend or repeat flights when regulatory counts/hours remain unmet.

Look for: Maintains orientation, uses lighting deliberately, and chooses go-around or termination before visual illusion or fatigue affects control.

Watch / correct: Black-hole approach cues - use a stabilized approach and available visual/electronic guidance.

Watch / correct: Counts drive rushed circuits - accept sequencing delays or finish the remaining counts another flight.

Stop / transition: End the flight for fatigue, deteriorating visibility, lighting/tower changes affecting the plan, or unstable approaches.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Night orientation and tower pattern work; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.

- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.

- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief - 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Tower Controlled Airport Operations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Reconcile the required night hours and towered takeoff/landing counts across the actual flights. A 78-minute source target cannot guarantee required counts in traffic; extend or repeat when needed.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 11 - source page 32 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 12 · VFR diversion and lost-position review

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-45 Air 08-40	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
45-77 Air 40-72	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 12

Practice vfr diversion and lost-position review. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 32 minutes

Teach / coach: Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 32 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.

- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Flow Checks. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PIC Brief. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Division of Responsibilities. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Sterile Cockpit. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D.). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 12 - source page 33 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 13 · Stage I navigation assessment

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min check | Brief 39 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 21

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-51 Air 08-46	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
51-89 Air 46-84	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
89-107 Air 84-102	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
107-117 Air 102-112	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
117-120 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 13

Assess independent performance and decisions using current FAA criteria; pause coaching except to protect safety.

Source clarification: The publisher lesson page and allocation table differ. This guide uses the lesson page: instrument subset: lesson page 18 min; allocation table 0 min. Compare the linked source pages before dispatch. The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 39 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Assess the learner's departure, configuration, and course intercept independently; give no coaching during the check.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 38 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed vfr route management and diversion scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 38 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed takeoff, landing, and go-around technique scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed build the scan and trim loop scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 21 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Physiological Aspects of Night Flying. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go- Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Flow Checks. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PIC Brief. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Division of Responsibilities. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Sterile Cockpit. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 13 - source page 35, 36 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Complex operational environments

Practice high workload destinations, avionics, IFR routes, performance limitations, and an authorized international scenario.

Lesson 14 · Preparation: Use of the Airman Certification Standards, Aircraft Equipment and Operational Requirements & L...

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 15 · Commercial precision baseline

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-25 Air 08-20	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition.
25-37 Air 20-32	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
37-48 Air 32-43	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
48-59 Air 43-54	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
59-77 Air 54-72	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 15

Practice commercial precision baseline. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The publisher lesson page and allocation table differ. This guide uses the lesson page: dual flight: lesson page 90 min; allocation table 78 min. Compare the linked source pages before dispatch. The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria.

Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Variations in Climbs. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Variations in Range. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Variations in Endurance. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Unusual Attitude Recovery with V.L.D. (Full & Partial Panel). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 15 - source page 38 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 16 · Independent precision practice

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-31 Air 08-26	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight...
31-48 Air 26-43	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Independently: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
48-65 Air 43-60	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 16

Practice independent precision practice. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria. Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 16 - source page 39 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 17 · Preparation: National Airspace System, Procurement & Use of Aviation Weather, Reports & Forecasts

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation](#); assignments on the referenced TCO pages

[FAA aviation handbooks](#); use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 18 · Dual high traffic cross-country

[Return to lesson index](#)

240 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-45 Air 08-40	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
45-77 Air 40-72	[] High traffic and complex airport operations	Obtain required clearances, monitor the traffic/ATC picture, verify runway assignments aloud, and comply with speed/route instructions within aircraft limits.
77-227 Air 72-222	[] Instrument route control and avionics	Under the agreed actual or simulated instrument conditions, control attitude/airspeed/altitude, intercept and track the route, verify GPS/VOR sources and...
227-237 Air 222-232	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
237-240 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 18

Practice dual high traffic cross-country. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 150-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Uses explicit clearances, avoids fixation and runway confusion, and asks for time before capacity is exceeded.
- Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 32 minutes

Teach / coach: Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

High traffic and complex airport operations · 32 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief current airport diagrams, hotspots, arrival routes, frequencies, clearances, wake turbulence, and escape options. Dual sessions model concise communication and workload allocation; independent sessions require the pilot to explain a plan for an amended clearance.

Student exercise: Obtain required clearances, monitor the traffic/ATC picture, verify runway assignments aloud, and comply with speed/route instructions within aircraft limits. Request clarification, delay, vectors, or go-around whenever the clearance or landing picture is unsafe.

Practice: One high workload arrival/departure, one amended instruction, and a runway-assignment cross-check.

Look for: Uses explicit clearances, avoids fixation and runway confusion, and asks for time before capacity is exceeded.

Watch / correct: Following traffic without own clearance - verify the actual clearance and runway.

Watch / correct: ATC request exceeds capability - respond unable and propose a safe alternative.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the planned destination when traffic, winds, runway, or workload prevents safe compliance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; High traffic and complex airport operations; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Instrument route control and avionics · 150 minutes

Teach / coach: Establish the approved lookout/control arrangement, instrument training role, and navigation source. During the route teach a reliable attitude scan, course intercept/tracking, clearance-style heading/altitude changes, and one realistic backup-control scenario without compromising actual equipment. This can be legal VFR simulated instrument; actual IFR requires qualified/currency-compliant pilot roles, aircraft, and clearance.

Student exercise: Under the agreed actual or simulated instrument conditions, control attitude/airspeed/altitude, intercept and track the route, verify GPS/VOR sources and sequencing, manage amended headings/altitudes, then recover a briefed backup-control scenario. Remove the view-limiting device for arrivals/traffic when required by the safety arrangement. Plan 150 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Sustain the published instrument subset across the route segment; include two course intercepts, two level-offs, one source change, and one approved backup-control review.

Look for: Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.

Watch / correct: Continuing toward deteriorating weather - identify the last safe alternate and decide before reaching it.

Watch / correct: Clearance lost in the flight plan - compare active route against the actual amended clearance.

Stop / transition: Real weather, aircraft capability, or fuel margin controls the route; terminate a training scenario before it reduces safe options.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Instrument route control and avionics; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Localizer Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: ILS Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Circling Approach Procedure. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Descent. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Holding Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Air Traffic Control Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Compliance with Departure, En Route, & Arrival Procedures / Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 18 - source page 41 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 19 · Preparation: Garmin G1000, Line Replaceable Units, Primary Flight Display (PFD)

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 20 · Glass cockpit VFR workflow

[Return to lesson index](#)

96 min device | Brief 15 | Preflight 10 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Device	[] Device setup and clearance review	Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.
08-36 Device	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
36-64 Device	[] GPS setup, sequencing, and integrity	Load and verify a short route, intercept an active leg, observe waypoint sequencing, accept a reroute with direct-to, then choose an appropriate nearest...
64-91 Device	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
91-96 Device	[] Secure device and verify results	Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 20

Practice glass cockpit vfr workflow. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Verifies every clearance and active leg, understands available guidance, and preserves control while programming.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Device setup and clearance review · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Verify the device configuration, intended training credit, database and weather scenario. Set failures only by the approved device method; state whether pauses are instruction or evaluation.

Student exercise: Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.

Practice: One complete setup and clearance readback.

Look for: Can explain the actual simulated aircraft/equipment state before the scenario runs.

Watch / correct: Unverified setup - compare the device state with the intended aircraft/manual.

Stop / transition: Do not log unapproved credit or continue with an invalid configuration.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 28 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

GPS setup, sequencing, and integrity · 28 minutes

Teach / coach: Use the installed navigator manual to show source selection, flight-plan loading, leg activation, direct-to, nearest, and scaling changes. Explain integrity alerts and how WAAS/RAIM availability affects a planned procedure; confirm the next mode before changing it.

Student exercise: Load and verify a short route, intercept an active leg, observe waypoint sequencing, accept a reroute with direct-to, then choose an appropriate nearest alternate. State navigation source, active leg, scaling, and response to an integrity alert.

Practice: One complete route plus one reroute and one integrity/failure decision.

Look for: Verifies every clearance and active leg, understands available guidance, and preserves control while programming.

Watch / correct: Wrong leg activated - compare clearance, map, flight-plan list, and CDI before executing.

Watch / correct: Heads-down programming - stabilize first; ask for delay or use a simpler navigation method.

Stop / transition: Stop programming for control/traffic priorities; discontinue approach guidance when integrity or required equipment is unavailable.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; GPS setup, sequencing, and integrity; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 27 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secure device and verify results · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Stop the scenario after a stable endpoint, review objective evidence, and distinguish simulated/device time from aircraft or airborne time.

Student exercise: Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Practice: One complete scenario wrap-up.

Look for: Ends with an accurate account of what was practiced and what remains.

Watch / correct: Treating paused time as flight - record only credit permitted by the device authorization.

Stop / transition: End before fatigue makes further practice ineffective.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 20 - source page 43 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 21 · Independent handling consolidation

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-31 Air 08-26	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight...
31-48 Air 26-43	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Independently: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
48-65 Air 43-60	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 21

Practice independent handling consolidation. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria. Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 21 - source page 44 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 22 · Glass cockpit IFR workflow

[Return to lesson index](#)

96 min device | Brief 15 | Preflight 10 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Device	[] Device setup and clearance review	Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.
08-25 Device	[] GPS setup, sequencing, and integrity	Load and verify a short route, intercept an active leg, observe waypoint sequencing, accept a reroute with direct-to, then choose an appropriate nearest...
25-42 Device	[] IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions	File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg.
42-59 Device	[] Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction	Copy and verify the clearance, select a defensible entry, cross the fix, establish the hold, and adjust outbound timing/distance and heading for wind.
59-75 Device	[] Lateral approach and missed approach	Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or...
75-91 Device	[] ILS and approved vertical guidance	Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized...
91-96 Device	[] Secure device and verify results	Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 22

Practice glass cockpit ifr workflow. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Verifies every clearance and active leg, understands available guidance, and preserves control while programming.
- Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.
- Remains within the protected procedure, meets altitude/speed constraints, and corrects timing without losing control.
- Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.
- Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Device setup and clearance review · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Verify the device configuration, intended training credit, database and weather scenario. Set failures only by the approved device method; state whether pauses are instruction or evaluation.

Student exercise: Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.

Practice: One complete setup and clearance readback.

Look for: Can explain the actual simulated aircraft/equipment state before the scenario runs.

Watch / correct: Unverified setup - compare the device state with the intended aircraft/manual.

Stop / transition: Do not log unapproved credit or continue with an invalid configuration.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

GPS setup, sequencing, and integrity · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Use the installed navigator manual to show source selection, flight-plan loading, leg activation, direct-to, nearest, and scaling changes. Explain integrity alerts and how WAAS/RAIM availability affects a planned procedure; confirm the next mode before changing it.

Student exercise: Load and verify a short route, intercept an active leg, observe waypoint sequencing, accept a reroute with direct-to, then choose an appropriate nearest alternate. State navigation source, active leg, scaling, and response to an integrity alert.

Practice: One complete route plus one reroute and one integrity/failure decision.

Look for: Verifies every clearance and active leg, understands available guidance, and preserves control while programming.

Watch / correct: Wrong leg activated - compare clearance, map, flight-plan list, and CDI before executing.

Watch / correct: Heads-down programming - stabilize first; ask for delay or use a simpler navigation method.

Stop / transition: Stop programming for control/traffic priorities; discontinue approach guidance when integrity or required equipment is unavailable.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; GPS setup, sequencing, and integrity; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Build an actual route with current weather, NOTAMs, alternates, fuel, departure/arrival restrictions, and approach options. In flight present one credible weather or routing change and require a decision supported by fuel and aircraft capability; rehearse lost communications without stopping real radio use.

Student exercise: File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg. Select an alternate before the escape option disappears; explain the applicable lost-communications response and request assistance while communications work.

Practice: At least two route checkpoints, one changed-clearance readback, one diversion decision, and approaches at planned destinations.

Look for: Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.

Watch / correct: Continuing toward deteriorating weather - identify the last safe alternate and decide before reaching it.

Watch / correct: Clearance lost in the flight plan - compare active route against the actual amended clearance.

Stop / transition: Real weather, aircraft capability, or fuel margin controls the route; terminate a training scenario before it reduces safe options.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the learner read back and sketch the clearance, fix, course, direction, restriction, and expect-further-clearance information. Demonstrate fix-crossing flow and one entry; explain that the chosen entry must remain within protected airspace.

Student exercise: Copy and verify the clearance, select a defensible entry, cross the fix, establish the hold, and adjust outbound timing/distance and heading for wind. Communicate any inability and track clearance limits.

Practice: Two entries from different arrival directions and two complete circuits; one timed and one distance-based hold when available.

Look for: Remains within the protected procedure, meets altitude/speed constraints, and corrects timing without losing control.

Watch / correct: Entry guessed from a moving display - orient the published inbound course and aircraft arrival direction before choosing.

Watch / correct: Timing starts at the wrong place - identify the published timing convention and fix crossing.

Stop / transition: Request clarification or vectors before reaching an unclear limit; abandon exercise for unsafe control or containment.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lateral approach and missed approach · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief procedure eligibility, source, course, altitudes, MDA, missed point, visual requirements, and missed route. Demonstrate a stabilized descent using approved advisory vertical guidance only as advisory; distinguish LNAV/LP from vertically guided minima.

Student exercise: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or missed approach. At the missed point, execute the aircraft procedure, navigation sequence, and ATC report.

Practice: One complete approach and one vectored approach; at least one missed approach.

Look for: Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.

Watch / correct: Advisory glidepath treated as authorization below MDA - use the selected chart minima and required visual conditions.

Watch / correct: Early descent after a shortcut - verify the cleared segment and remaining altitude restrictions.

Stop / transition: Go missed when required by the clearance/procedure, guidance loss, unstable approach, or unmet landing conditions.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lateral approach and missed approach; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

ILS and approved vertical guidance · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Contrast ILS, LPV, and LNAV/VNAV guidance, minima, equipment requirements, and failure responses. LP provides lateral guidance only; it is not an APV. For test credit, consult current ACS conditions for the selected LPV procedure rather than labeling every LPV a precision approach.

Student exercise: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized configuration, and follow lateral/vertical guidance to the selected DA. Execute a missed approach when the required visual conditions are absent.

Practice: Two approaches with different guidance where available: one landing transition and one missed approach.

Look for: Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Watch / correct: Wrong CDI source - verify the source before intercept and compare with the chart.

Watch / correct: Below-path correction by steep descent - recover a stable path or go missed; do not chase near the ground.

Stop / transition: Go missed for lost required guidance, instability, unavailable visual conditions, or an instruction requiring it.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; ILS and approved vertical guidance; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secure device and verify results · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Stop the scenario after a stable endpoint, review objective evidence, and distinguish simulated/device time from aircraft or airborne time.

Student exercise: Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Practice: One complete scenario wrap-up.

Look for: Ends with an accurate account of what was practiced and what remains.

Watch / correct: Treating paused time as flight - record only credit permitted by the device authorization.

Stop / transition: End before fatigue makes further practice ineffective.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Radial Interception & Tracking. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 22 - source page 45 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 23 · High traffic PIC destination

[Return to lesson index](#)

420 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-328 Air 08-323	[] VFR route management and diversion	Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
328-407 Air 323-402	[] High traffic and complex airport operations	Independently: Obtain required clearances, monitor the traffic/ATC picture, verify runway assignments aloud, and comply with speed/route instructions within...
407-417 Air 402-412	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
417-420 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 23

Practice high traffic pic destination. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Uses explicit clearances, avoids fixation and runway confusion, and asks for time before capacity is exceeded.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 315 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

High traffic and complex airport operations · 79 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief current airport diagrams, hotspots, arrival routes, frequencies, clearances, wake turbulence, and escape options. Dual sessions model concise communication and workload allocation; independent sessions require the pilot to explain a plan for an amended clearance. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Obtain required clearances, monitor the traffic/ATC picture, verify runway assignments aloud, and comply with speed/route instructions within aircraft limits. Request clarification, delay, vectors, or go-around whenever the clearance or landing picture is unsafe.

Practice: One high workload arrival/departure, one amended instruction, and a runway-assignment cross-check.

Look for: Uses explicit clearances, avoids fixation and runway confusion, and asks for time before capacity is exceeded.

Watch / correct: Following traffic without own clearance - verify the actual clearance and runway.

Watch / correct: ATC request exceeds capability - respond unable and propose a safe alternative.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the planned destination when traffic, winds, runway, or workload prevents safe compliance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; High traffic and complex airport operations; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: User & Other Fees. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 23 - source page 46 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 24 · Glass cockpit restrictions and failures

[Return to lesson index](#)

96 min device | Brief 15 | Preflight 10 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Device	[] Device setup and clearance review	Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.
08-29 Device	[] IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions	File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg.
29-50 Device	[] Failure recognition and backup control	Identify the simulated failed instrument, cross-check its reliability, establish control with valid indications, and use backup attitude/heading resources.
50-71 Device	[] Lateral approach and missed approach	Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or...
71-91 Device	[] ILS and approved vertical guidance	Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized...
91-96 Device	[] Secure device and verify results	Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 24

Practice glass cockpit restrictions and failures. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.
- Rejects misleading data, controls the aircraft with valid sources, and communicates the degraded capability.
- Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.
- Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Device setup and clearance review · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Verify the device configuration, intended training credit, database and weather scenario. Set failures only by the approved device method; state whether pauses are instruction or evaluation.

Student exercise: Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.

Practice: One complete setup and clearance readback.

Look for: Can explain the actual simulated aircraft/equipment state before the scenario runs.

Watch / correct: Unverified setup - compare the device state with the intended aircraft/manual.

Stop / transition: Do not log unapproved credit or continue with an invalid configuration.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Build an actual route with current weather, NOTAMs, alternates, fuel, departure/arrival restrictions, and approach options. In flight present one credible weather or routing change and require a decision supported by fuel and aircraft capability; rehearse lost communications without stopping real radio use.

Student exercise: File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg. Select an alternate before the escape option disappears; explain the applicable lost-communications response and request assistance while communications work.

Practice: At least two route checkpoints, one changed-clearance readback, one diversion decision, and approaches at planned destinations.

Look for: Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.

Watch / correct: Continuing toward deteriorating weather - identify the last safe alternate and decide before reaching it.

Watch / correct: Clearance lost in the flight plan - compare active route against the actual amended clearance.

Stop / transition: Real weather, aircraft capability, or fuel margin controls the route; terminate a training scenario before it reduces safe options.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Failure recognition and backup control · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief a realistic failure supported by the aircraft or device. Reveal its indications, require independent confirmation, then demonstrate the remaining scan. Never disable equipment that compromises the actual flight or required equipment.

Student exercise: Identify the simulated failed instrument, cross-check its reliability, establish control with valid indications, and use backup attitude/heading resources. Make timed turns and compass-supported turns with appropriate acceleration/dip error awareness.

Practice: Two different failures and one heading change each direction; device sessions may freeze only after the attempt for explanation.

Look for: Rejects misleading data, controls the aircraft with valid sources, and communicates the degraded capability.

Watch / correct: Following a failed display - cross-check independent indications and isolate the bad source.

Watch / correct: Treating compass as steady during a maneuver - stabilize before reading and use timed/backup methods as appropriate.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for loss of orientation, unsafe deviations, unavailable reliable backup, or real equipment abnormality.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Failure recognition and backup control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lateral approach and missed approach · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief procedure eligibility, source, course, altitudes, MDA, missed point, visual requirements, and missed route. Demonstrate a stabilized descent using approved advisory vertical guidance only as advisory; distinguish LNAV/LP from vertically guided minima.

Student exercise: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or missed approach. At the missed point, execute the aircraft procedure, navigation sequence, and ATC report.

Practice: One complete approach and one vectored approach; at least one missed approach.

Look for: Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.

Watch / correct: Advisory glidepath treated as authorization below MDA - use the selected chart minima and required visual conditions.

Watch / correct: Early descent after a shortcut - verify the cleared segment and remaining altitude restrictions.

Stop / transition: Go missed when required by the clearance/procedure, guidance loss, unstable approach, or unmet landing conditions.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lateral approach and missed approach; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

ILS and approved vertical guidance · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Contrast ILS, LPV, and LNAV/VNAV guidance, minima, equipment requirements, and failure responses. LP provides lateral guidance only; it is not an APV. For test credit, consult current ACS conditions for the selected LPV procedure rather than labeling every LPV a precision approach.

Student exercise: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized configuration, and follow lateral/vertical guidance to the selected DA. Execute a missed approach when the required visual conditions are absent.

Practice: Two approaches with different guidance where available: one landing transition and one missed approach.

Look for: Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Watch / correct: Wrong CDI source - verify the source before intercept and compare with the chart.

Watch / correct: Below-path correction by steep descent - recover a stable path or go missed; do not chase near the ground.

Stop / transition: Go missed for lost required guidance, instability, unavailable visual conditions, or an instruction requiring it.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; ILS and approved vertical guidance; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secure device and verify results · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Stop the scenario after a stable endpoint, review objective evidence, and distinguish simulated/device time from aircraft or airborne time.

Student exercise: Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Practice: One complete scenario wrap-up.

Look for: Ends with an accurate account of what was practiced and what remains.

Watch / correct: Treating paused time as flight - record only credit permitted by the device authorization.

Stop / transition: End before fatigue makes further practice ineffective.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Abnormal & Emergency Procedures Related to the G1000. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 24 - source page 47 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 25 · Performance-limited PIC destination

[Return to lesson index](#)

360 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-235 Air 08-230	[] VFR route management and diversion	Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
235-291 Air 230-286	[] Performance-limited destination decisions	Independently: Recalculate performance before committing to the destination, identify terrain and wind cues, select a safe approach/departure path, and retain...
291-347 Air 286-342	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
347-357 Air 342-352	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
357-360 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 25

Practice performance-limited pic destination. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Supports go/no-go decisions with current conditions and usable aircraft data, preserving terrain and runway margins.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 222 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Performance-limited destination decisions · 56 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Use actual weight, density altitude, runway surface/slope, obstacles, winds, and POH data to compare destination options. Brief terrain escape routes, turbulence, and turnaround/abort gates. The objective is a sound decision, including declining the landing. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Recalculate performance before committing to the destination, identify terrain and wind cues, select a safe approach/departure path, and retain an alternate. Fly only approved short/soft-field procedures with adequate calculated margins.

Practice: One arrival/departure decision and one alternative-airport decision; repeat performance calculations after a changed condition.

Look for: Supports go/no-go decisions with current conditions and usable aircraft data, preserving terrain and runway margins.

Watch / correct: Sea-level habit applied at altitude - recalculate and use the actual aircraft procedure.

Watch / correct: Destination commitment bias - compare the alternate before commencing the approach.

Stop / transition: Reject takeoff or divert if required performance/terrain margins cannot be established.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Performance-limited destination decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 56 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Wind Shear Recognition & Avoidance. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: High Density Altitude Airports. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 25 - source page 48 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 26 · Dual IFR route and monitoring duties

[Return to lesson index](#)

240 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-108 Air 08-103	[] IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions	File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg.
108-132 Air 103-127	[] High traffic and complex airport operations	Obtain required clearances, monitor the traffic/ATC picture, verify runway assignments aloud, and comply with speed/route instructions within aircraft limits.
132-180 Air 127-175	[] Lateral approach and missed approach	Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or...
180-227 Air 175-222	[] ILS and approved vertical guidance	Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized...
227-237 Air 222-232	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
237-240 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 26

Practice dual ifr route and monitoring duties. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 150-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.
- Uses explicit clearances, avoids fixation and runway confusion, and asks for time before capacity is exceeded.
- Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.
- Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions · 95 minutes

Teach / coach: Build an actual route with current weather, NOTAMs, alternates, fuel, departure/arrival restrictions, and approach options. In flight present one credible weather or routing change and require a decision supported by fuel and aircraft capability; rehearse lost communications without stopping real radio use.

Student exercise: File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg. Select an alternate before the escape option disappears; explain the applicable lost-communications response and request assistance while communications work. Plan 95 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: At least two route checkpoints, one changed-clearance readback, one diversion decision, and approaches at planned destinations.

Look for: Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.

Watch / correct: Continuing toward deteriorating weather - identify the last safe alternate and decide before reaching it.

Watch / correct: Clearance lost in the flight plan - compare active route against the actual amended clearance.

Stop / transition: Real weather, aircraft capability, or fuel margin controls the route; terminate a training scenario before it reduces safe options.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

High traffic and complex airport operations · 24 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief current airport diagrams, hotspots, arrival routes, frequencies, clearances, wake turbulence, and escape options. Dual sessions model concise communication and workload allocation; independent sessions require the pilot to explain a plan for an amended clearance.

Student exercise: Obtain required clearances, monitor the traffic/ATC picture, verify runway assignments aloud, and comply with speed/route instructions within aircraft limits. Request clarification, delay, vectors, or go-around whenever the clearance or landing picture is unsafe.

Practice: One high workload arrival/departure, one amended instruction, and a runway-assignment cross-check.

Look for: Uses explicit clearances, avoids fixation and runway confusion, and asks for time before capacity is exceeded.

Watch / correct: Following traffic without own clearance - verify the actual clearance and runway.

Watch / correct: ATC request exceeds capability - respond unable and propose a safe alternative.

Stop / transition: Discontinue the planned destination when traffic, winds, runway, or workload prevents safe compliance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; High traffic and complex airport operations; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lateral approach and missed approach - 48 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief procedure eligibility, source, course, altitudes, MDA, missed point, visual requirements, and missed route. Demonstrate a stabilized descent using approved advisory vertical guidance only as advisory; distinguish LNAV/LP from vertically guided minima.

Student exercise: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or missed approach. At the missed point, execute the aircraft procedure, navigation sequence, and ATC report. Plan 48 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One complete approach and one vectored approach; at least one missed approach.

Look for: Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.

Watch / correct: Advisory glidepath treated as authorization below MDA - use the selected chart minima and required visual conditions.

Watch / correct: Early descent after a shortcut - verify the cleared segment and remaining altitude restrictions.

Stop / transition: Go missed when required by the clearance/procedure, guidance loss, unstable approach, or unmet landing conditions.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lateral approach and missed approach; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

ILS and approved vertical guidance - 47 minutes

Teach / coach: Contrast ILS, LPV, and LNAV/VNAV guidance, minima, equipment requirements, and failure responses. LP provides lateral guidance only; it is not an APV. For test credit, consult current ACS conditions for the selected LPV procedure rather than labeling every LPV a precision approach.

Student exercise: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized configuration, and follow lateral/vertical guidance to the selected DA. Execute a missed approach when the required visual conditions are absent. Plan 7 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two approaches with different guidance where available: one landing transition and one missed approach.

Look for: Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Watch / correct: Wrong CDI source - verify the source before intercept and compare with the chart.

Watch / correct: Below-path correction by steep descent - recover a stable path or go missed; do not chase near the ground.

Stop / transition: Go missed for lost required guidance, instability, unavailable visual conditions, or an instruction requiring it.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; ILS and approved vertical guidance; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Pilotage / Dead Reckoning. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: ATC Radar Services. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Radial Interception & Tracking (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Circling Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D.). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Descent. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Holding Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Air Traffic Control Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Pilot Not Flying (Pilot Monitoring) Duties. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Challenge & Response Checklist Usage. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Flow Checks. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Sterile Cockpit. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PIC Brief. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Departure Briefing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Division of Responsibilities. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 26 - source page 49 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 27 · PIC multi-airport IFR route

[Return to lesson index](#)

180 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-90 Air 08-85	[] IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions	Independently: File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg.
90-129 Air 85-124	[] Lateral approach and missed approach	Independently: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a...
129-167 Air 124-162	[] ILS and approved vertical guidance	Independently: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a...
167-177 Air 162-172	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
177-180 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 27

Practice pic multi-airport ifr route. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.
- Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.
- Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.
- Actual IFR PIC gate: the actual PIC must hold the appropriate instrument privileges, meet current IFR recency/proficiency requirements, and fly an IFR-airworthy/equipped aircraft under the required clearance. Confirm actual pilot roles and logbook eligibility. If these gates are absent, use only a legal VFR/simulated-instrument exercise with a qualified safety-pilot/lookout arrangement where required; do not execute or log actual IFR by assumption.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions · 77 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Build an actual route with current weather, NOTAMs, alternates, fuel, departure/arrival restrictions, and approach options. In flight present one credible weather or routing change and require a decision supported by fuel and aircraft capability; rehearse lost communications without stopping real radio use. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg. Select an alternate before the escape option disappears; explain the applicable lost-communications response and request assistance while communications work.

Practice: At least two route checkpoints, one changed-clearance readback, one diversion decision, and approaches at planned destinations.

Look for: Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.

Watch / correct: Continuing toward deteriorating weather - identify the last safe alternate and decide before reaching it.

Watch / correct: Clearance lost in the flight plan - compare active route against the actual amended clearance.

Stop / transition: Real weather, aircraft capability, or fuel margin controls the route; terminate a training scenario before it reduces safe options.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lateral approach and missed approach · 39 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief procedure eligibility, source, course, altitudes, MDA, missed point, visual requirements, and missed route. Demonstrate a stabilized descent using approved advisory vertical guidance only as advisory; distinguish LNAV/LP from vertically guided minima. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or missed approach. At the missed point, execute the aircraft procedure, navigation sequence, and ATC report.

Practice: One complete approach and one vectored approach; at least one missed approach.

Look for: Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.

Watch / correct: Advisory glidepath treated as authorization below MDA - use the selected chart minima and required visual conditions.

Watch / correct: Early descent after a shortcut - verify the cleared segment and remaining altitude restrictions.

Stop / transition: Go missed when required by the clearance/procedure, guidance loss, unstable approach, or unmet landing conditions.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lateral approach and missed approach; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

ILS and approved vertical guidance · 38 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Contrast ILS, LPV, and LNAV/VNAV guidance, minima, equipment requirements, and failure responses. LP provides lateral guidance only; it is not an APV. For test credit, consult current ACS conditions for the selected LPV procedure rather than labeling every LPV a precision approach. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized configuration, and follow lateral/vertical guidance to the selected DA. Execute a missed approach when the required visual conditions are absent.

Practice: Two approaches with different guidance where available: one landing transition and one missed approach.

Look for: Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Watch / correct: Wrong CDI source - verify the source before intercept and compare with the chart.

Watch / correct: Below-path correction by steep descent - recover a stable path or go missed; do not chase near the ground.

Stop / transition: Go missed for lost required guidance, instability, unavailable visual conditions, or an instruction requiring it.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; ILS and approved vertical guidance; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Pilotage / Dead Reckoning. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: ATC Radar Services. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Diversion. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Lost Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Wind Shear Recognition & Avoidance. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Radial Interception & Tracking (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Circling Approach Procedure. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D. if a safety pilot is available). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 27 - source page 50 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 28 · Glass cockpit automation and abnormal work

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min device | Brief 15 | Preflight 10 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Device	[] Device setup and clearance review	Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.
08-30 Device	[] Autopilot modes and manual reversion	Select heading, navigation, altitude, and permitted climb/descent modes.
30-52 Device	[] Failure recognition and backup control	Identify the simulated failed instrument, cross-check its reliability, establish control with valid indications, and use backup attitude/heading resources.
52-73 Device	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
73-94 Device	[] Lateral approach and missed approach	Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or...
94-115 Device	[] ILS and approved vertical guidance	Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized...
115-120 Device	[] Secure device and verify results	Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 28

Practice glass cockpit automation and abnormal work. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Monitors rather than assumes automation behavior; disconnects early when it no longer supports the plan.
- Rejects misleading data, controls the aircraft with valid sources, and communicates the degraded capability.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.
- Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Device setup and clearance review · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Verify the device configuration, intended training credit, database and weather scenario. Set failures only by the approved device method; state whether pauses are instruction or evaluation.

Student exercise: Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.

Practice: One complete setup and clearance readback.

Look for: Can explain the actual simulated aircraft/equipment state before the scenario runs.

Watch / correct: Unverified setup - compare the device state with the intended aircraft/manual.

Stop / transition: Do not log unapproved credit or continue with an invalid configuration.

Autopilot modes and manual reversion - 22 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved engagement envelope, limitations, disconnect methods, and failure signs. Demonstrate each installed mode by stating what is armed, active, commanded, and actually happening; then disconnect and hand-fly the same segment.

Student exercise: Select heading, navigation, altitude, and permitted climb/descent modes. Confirm annunciations and resulting flight path after every change. Recover from a simulated wrong mode or failed automation using the approved disconnect and manual control.

Practice: One mode sequence, one capture verification, and two different disconnect/reversion methods if installed.

Look for: Monitors rather than assumes automation behavior; disconnects early when it no longer supports the plan.

Watch / correct: Armed mistaken for active - point to annunciations and confirm actual capture.

Watch / correct: Fighting engaged servos - use the approved disconnect and stabilize manually.

Stop / transition: Disengage for unexpected flight path, unresolved mode confusion, or operation outside approved limitations.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Autopilot modes and manual reversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Failure recognition and backup control - 22 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief a realistic failure supported by the aircraft or device. Reveal its indications, require independent confirmation, then demonstrate the remaining scan. Never disable equipment that compromises the actual flight or required equipment.

Student exercise: Identify the simulated failed instrument, cross-check its reliability, establish control with valid indications, and use backup attitude/heading resources. Make timed turns and compass-supported turns with appropriate acceleration/dip error awareness.

Practice: Two different failures and one heading change each direction; device sessions may freeze only after the attempt for explanation.

Look for: Rejects misleading data, controls the aircraft with valid sources, and communicates the degraded capability.

Watch / correct: Following a failed display - cross-check independent indications and isolate the bad source.

Watch / correct: Treating compass as steady during a maneuver - stabilize before reading and use timed/backup methods as appropriate.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for loss of orientation, unsafe deviations, unavailable reliable backup, or real equipment abnormality.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Failure recognition and backup control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options - 21 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lateral approach and missed approach · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief procedure eligibility, source, course, altitudes, MDA, missed point, visual requirements, and missed route. Demonstrate a stabilized descent using approved advisory vertical guidance only as advisory; distinguish LNAV/LP from vertically guided minima.

Student exercise: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or missed approach. At the missed point, execute the aircraft procedure, navigation sequence, and ATC report.

Practice: One complete approach and one vectored approach; at least one missed approach.

Look for: Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.

Watch / correct: Advisory glidepath treated as authorization below MDA - use the selected chart minima and required visual conditions.

Watch / correct: Early descent after a shortcut - verify the cleared segment and remaining altitude restrictions.

Stop / transition: Go missed when required by the clearance/procedure, guidance loss, unstable approach, or unmet landing conditions.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lateral approach and missed approach; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

ILS and approved vertical guidance · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Contrast ILS, LPV, and LNAV/VNAV guidance, minima, equipment requirements, and failure responses. LP provides lateral guidance only; it is not an APV. For test credit, consult current ACS conditions for the selected LPV procedure rather than labeling every LPV a precision approach.

Student exercise: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized configuration, and follow lateral/vertical guidance to the selected DA. Execute a missed approach when the required visual conditions are absent.

Practice: Two approaches with different guidance where available: one landing transition and one missed approach.

Look for: Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Watch / correct: Wrong CDI source - verify the source before intercept and compare with the chart.

Watch / correct: Below-path correction by steep descent - recover a stable path or go missed; do not chase near the ground.

Stop / transition: Go missed for lost required guidance, instability, unavailable visual conditions, or an instruction requiring it.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; ILS and approved vertical guidance; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secure device and verify results · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Stop the scenario after a stable endpoint, review objective evidence, and distinguish simulated/device time from aircraft or airborne time.

Student exercise: Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Practice: One complete scenario wrap-up.

Look for: Ends with an accurate account of what was practiced and what remains.

Watch / correct: Treating paused time as flight - record only credit permitted by the device authorization.

Stop / transition: End before fatigue makes further practice ineffective.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Compliance with Departure, En Route, & Arrival Procedures / Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Climb Via Departure Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Descend Via Arrival Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 28 - source page 51 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 29 · PIC IFR route refinement

[Return to lesson index](#)

180 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-90 Air 08-85	[] IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions	Independently: File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg.
90-129 Air 85-124	[] Lateral approach and missed approach	Independently: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a...
129-167 Air 124-162	[] ILS and approved vertical guidance	Independently: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a...
167-177 Air 162-172	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
177-180 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 29

Practice pic ifr route refinement. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.
- Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.
- Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.
- Actual IFR PIC gate: the actual PIC must hold the appropriate instrument privileges, meet current IFR recency/proficiency requirements, and fly an IFR-airworthy/equipped aircraft under the required clearance. Confirm actual pilot roles and logbook eligibility. If these gates are absent, use only a legal VFR/simulated-instrument exercise with a qualified safety-pilot/lookout arrangement where required; do not execute or log actual IFR by assumption.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions · 77 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Build an actual route with current weather, NOTAMs, alternates, fuel, departure/arrival restrictions, and approach options. In flight present one credible weather or routing change and require a decision supported by fuel and aircraft capability; rehearse lost communications without stopping real radio use. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: File the plan when appropriate, verify the clearance, fly the route and altitude restrictions, and update ETA/fuel/weather at each leg. Select an alternate before the escape option disappears; explain the applicable lost-communications response and request assistance while communications work.

Practice: At least two route checkpoints, one changed-clearance readback, one diversion decision, and approaches at planned destinations.

Look for: Remains ahead of route and weather, keeps reserves and terrain/airspace protection, and communicates changes promptly.

Watch / correct: Continuing toward deteriorating weather - identify the last safe alternate and decide before reaching it.

Watch / correct: Clearance lost in the flight plan - compare active route against the actual amended clearance.

Stop / transition: Real weather, aircraft capability, or fuel margin controls the route; terminate a training scenario before it reduces safe options.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; IFR route, weather, and contingency decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lateral approach and missed approach · 39 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief procedure eligibility, source, course, altitudes, MDA, missed point, visual requirements, and missed route. Demonstrate a stabilized descent using approved advisory vertical guidance only as advisory; distinguish LNAV/LP from vertically guided minima. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or missed approach. At the missed point, execute the aircraft procedure, navigation sequence, and ATC report.

Practice: One complete approach and one vectored approach; at least one missed approach.

Look for: Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.

Watch / correct: Advisory glidepath treated as authorization below MDA - use the selected chart minima and required visual conditions.

Watch / correct: Early descent after a shortcut - verify the cleared segment and remaining altitude restrictions.

Stop / transition: Go missed when required by the clearance/procedure, guidance loss, unstable approach, or unmet landing conditions.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lateral approach and missed approach; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

ILS and approved vertical guidance · 38 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Contrast ILS, LPV, and LNAV/VNAV guidance, minima, equipment requirements, and failure responses. LP provides lateral guidance only; it is not an APV. For test credit, consult current ACS conditions for the selected LPV procedure rather than labeling every LPV a precision approach. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized configuration, and follow lateral/vertical guidance to the selected DA. Execute a missed approach when the required visual conditions are absent.

Practice: Two approaches with different guidance where available: one landing transition and one missed approach.

Look for: Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Watch / correct: Wrong CDI source - verify the source before intercept and compare with the chart.

Watch / correct: Below-path correction by steep descent - recover a stable path or go missed; do not chase near the ground.

Stop / transition: Go missed for lost required guidance, instability, unavailable visual conditions, or an instruction requiring it.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; ILS and approved vertical guidance; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Pilotage / Dead Reckoning. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: ATC Radar Services. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Diversion. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Lost Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Wind Shear Recognition & Avoidance. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Radial Interception & Tracking (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Circling Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D. if a safety pilot is available). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 29 - source page 52 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 30 - Preparation: Required Documents for International Flights, International & Canadian / Bahamian Flight Plans...

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 31 · International PIC operation

[Return to lesson index](#)

240 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-56 Air 08-51	[] International route and border preparation	Independently: Conduct the approved international route with proper documents and permissions, verify boundary/reporting requirements, manage fuel and weather,...
56-227 Air 51-222	[] VFR route management and diversion	Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
227-237 Air 222-232	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
237-240 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 31

Practice international pic operation. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- No departure with unresolved entry/return requirements; route and fuel decisions remain independent of the training schedule.
- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

International route and border preparation · 43 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Before dispatch verify current destination rules, documents, customs/immigration requirements, advance permissions, flight-plan procedures, insurance, and return procedures from official sources. Do not assume the source's international exercise is a Part 61 certificate requirement. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Conduct the approved international route with proper documents and permissions, verify boundary/reporting requirements, manage fuel and weather, and complete arrival/return procedures. If permissions are unavailable, fly a domestic navigation exercise and complete the border scenario on the ground.

Practice: One outbound/return planning cycle and each required boundary/arrival check on the chosen authorized route.

Look for: No departure with unresolved entry/return requirements; route and fuel decisions remain independent of the training schedule.

Watch / correct: Old checklist assumed current - verify official requirements for the actual date and traveler.

Watch / correct: Paperwork done during a critical phase - complete it before departure or stabilize and delegate appropriately.

Stop / transition: Do not launch across a border until applicable permissions, documents, and safe return arrangements are confirmed.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; International route and border preparation; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

VFR route management and diversion · 171 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D. if a safety pilot is available). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Compliance with Departure, En Route, & Arrival Procedures / Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Radial Interception & Tracking (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR/VOR-DME Approach (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Localizer Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: ILS Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Circling Approach Procedure. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by

this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Customs Requirements. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Electronic Advance Passenger Information (eAPIS) Requirements and Use. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing Rights Airport. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Canadian / Bahamian Aviation Regulations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: General Declaration. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 31 - source page 54 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 32 · Stage II operational decisions assessment

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min check | Brief 39 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 21

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-39 Air 08-34	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
39-64 Air 34-59	[] Performance-limited destination decisions	Recalculate performance before committing to the destination, identify terrain and wind cues, select a safe approach/departure path, and retain an alternate.
64-89 Air 59-84	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
89-107 Air 84-102	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
107-117 Air 102-112	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
117-120 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 32

Assess independent performance and decisions using current FAA criteria; pause coaching except to protect safety.

Source clarification: The publisher lesson page and allocation table differ. This guide uses the lesson page: dual flight: lesson page 120 min; allocation table 90 min. Compare the linked source pages before dispatch. The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Supports go/no-go decisions with current conditions and usable aircraft data, preserving terrain and runway margins.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 39 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Assess the learner's departure, configuration, and course intercept independently; give no coaching during the check.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed vfr route management and diversion scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Performance-limited destination decisions · 25 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed performance-limited destination decisions scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Supports go/no-go decisions with current conditions and usable aircraft data, preserving terrain and runway margins. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Recalculate performance before committing to the destination, identify terrain and wind cues, select a safe approach/departure path, and retain an alternate. Fly only approved short/soft-field procedures with adequate calculated margins.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Supports go/no-go decisions with current conditions and usable aircraft data, preserving terrain and runway margins.

Watch / correct: Sea-level habit applied at altitude - recalculate and use the actual aircraft procedure.

Watch / correct: Destination commitment bias - compare the alternate before commencing the approach.

Stop / transition: Reject takeoff or divert if required performance/terrain margins cannot be established.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Performance-limited destination decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 25 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed takeoff, landing, and go-around technique scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed build the scan and trim loop scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 21 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Physiological Aspects of Night Flying. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Required Documents for International Flights. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Customs Requirements. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Canadian / Bahamian Aviation Regulations. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing Rights Airport. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: ADIZ. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: High Density Traffic Airports. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 32 - source page 56, 57 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Complex, TAA, and high-performance operations

Learn installed systems, configuration/energy management, abnormal decisions, and aircraft-specific proficiency.

Lesson 33 · Preparation: Pilot Qualifications for Complex and High-Performance Aircraft, Airworthiness Requirements, Pe...

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 34 · Complex or TAA device familiarization

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min device | Brief 20 | Preflight 10 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Device	[] Device setup and clearance review	Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.
08-34 Device	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
34-60 Device	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
60-85 Device	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
85-90 Device	[] Secure device and verify results	Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 34

Practice complex or taa device familiarization. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Device setup and clearance review · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Verify the device configuration, intended training credit, database and weather scenario. Set failures only by the approved device method; state whether pauses are instruction or evaluation.

Student exercise: Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.

Practice: One complete setup and clearance readback.

Look for: Can explain the actual simulated aircraft/equipment state before the scenario runs.

Watch / correct: Unverified setup - compare the device state with the intended aircraft/manual.

Stop / transition: Do not log unapproved credit or continue with an invalid configuration.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 26 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 25 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secure device and verify results · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Stop the scenario after a stable endpoint, review objective evidence, and distinguish simulated/device time from aircraft or airborne time.

Student exercise: Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Practice: One complete scenario wrap-up.

Look for: Ends with an accurate account of what was practiced and what remains.

Watch / correct: Treating paused time as flight - record only credit permitted by the device authorization.

Stop / transition: End before fatigue makes further practice ineffective.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Drag Demonstrations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Variations in Power Settings. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Constant Speed Propeller Operations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Retractable Landing Gear Operations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PFD/MFD/Autopilot Integration & Operations (TAA). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 34 - source page 59 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 35 · Complex or TAA device abnormal work

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min device | Brief 15 | Preflight 10 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Device	[] Device setup and clearance review	Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.
08-30 Device	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
30-52 Device	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
52-73 Device	[] Recognize and recover unusual attitudes	Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation...
73-78 Device	[] Secure device and verify results	Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 35

Practice complex or taa device abnormal work. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Device setup and clearance review · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Verify the device configuration, intended training credit, database and weather scenario. Set failures only by the approved device method; state whether pauses are instruction or evaluation.

Student exercise: Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.

Practice: One complete setup and clearance readback.

Look for: Can explain the actual simulated aircraft/equipment state before the scenario runs.

Watch / correct: Unverified setup - compare the device state with the intended aircraft/manual.

Stop / transition: Do not log unapproved credit or continue with an invalid configuration.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 22 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 22 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Recognize and recover unusual attitudes · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief transfer of control and the approved recovery procedure. Present modest, realistic unusual attitudes within aircraft limitations; demonstrate how reliable indications distinguish nose-high, nose-low, spiral, and failed-display situations.

Student exercise: Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation or automation confusion caused the upset.

Practice: One nose-high and one nose-low recovery; repeat using the briefed reduced instrument set if the source lesson calls for it.

Look for: Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Watch / correct: Control response before diagnosis - identify the attitude using reliable cues first.

Watch / correct: Recovery creates a secondary stall/overspeed - manage angle of attack, bank, power, and load according to the approved procedure.

Stop / transition: Instructor ends setup or takes control before aircraft limits, safety altitude, or recovery margin are threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Recognize and recover unusual attitudes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secure device and verify results · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Stop the scenario after a stable endpoint, review objective evidence, and distinguish simulated/device time from aircraft or airborne time.

Student exercise: Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Practice: One complete scenario wrap-up.

Look for: Ends with an accurate account of what was practiced and what remains.

Watch / correct: Treating paused time as flight - record only credit permitted by the device authorization.

Stop / transition: End before fatigue makes further practice ineffective.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Constant Speed Propellers Operations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Retractable Landing Gear Operations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PFD/MFD/Autopilot Integration & Operations (TAA). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 35 - source page 60 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 36 · Complex or TAA aircraft introduction

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-36 Air 08-31	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
36-59 Air 31-54	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
59-77 Air 54-72	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 36

Practice complex or taa aircraft introduction. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 23 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 23 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Drag Demonstrations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Variations in Power Settings. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Constant Speed Propellers Operations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Retractable Landing Gear Operations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PFD/MFD/Autopilot Integration & Operations (TAA). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Unusual Attitude Recovery with V.L.D. (Full & Partial Panel). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 36 - source page 61 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 37 · Configuration, slow flight, and emergencies

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-29 Air 08-24	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
29-44 Air 24-39	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
44-59 Air 39-54	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
59-77 Air 54-72	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 37

Practice configuration, slow flight, and emergencies. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.

- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Constant Speed Propeller Operations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Retractable Landing Gear Operations (Cx). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: PFD/MFD/Autopilot Integration & Operations (TAA). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Unusual Attitude Recovery with V.L.D. (Full & Partial Panel). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Lesson 38 · Complex or TAA handling refinement

[Return to lesson index](#)

108 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-35 Air 08-30	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
35-56 Air 30-51	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
56-77 Air 51-72	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
77-95 Air 72-90	[] Recognize and recover unusual attitudes	Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation...
95-105 Air 90-100	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
105-108 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 38

Practice complex or taa handling refinement. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The publisher lesson page and allocation table differ. This guide uses the lesson page: instrument subset: lesson page 18 min; allocation table 0 min. Compare the linked source pages before dispatch. The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 22 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues,

reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 21 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Recognize and recover unusual attitudes · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief transfer of control and the approved recovery procedure. Present modest, realistic unusual attitudes within aircraft limitations; demonstrate how reliable indications distinguish nose-high, nose-low, spiral, and failed-display situations.

Student exercise: Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation or automation confusion caused the upset. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One nose-high and one nose-low recovery; repeat using the briefed reduced instrument set if the source lesson calls for it.

Look for: Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Watch / correct: Control response before diagnosis - identify the attitude using reliable cues first.

Watch / correct: Recovery creates a secondary stall/overspeed - manage angle of attack, bank, power, and load according to the approved procedure.

Stop / transition: Instructor ends setup or takes control before aircraft limits, safety altitude, or recovery margin are threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Recognize and recover unusual attitudes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.

- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D.). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 38 - source page 63 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 39 · High-performance pattern introduction

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 27 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 15

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-25 Air 08-20	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
25-36 Air 20-31	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
36-47 Air 31-42	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
47-65 Air 42-60	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 39

Practice high-performance pattern introduction. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 27 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Any high-performance/complex endorsement requires the authorized instructor's actual aircraft-specific training and proficiency finding under §61.31. A TAA session does not establish complex-airplane proficiency by itself.
- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 15 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.

- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Unusual Attitude Recovery with V.L.D. (Full & Partial Panel). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 39 - source page 64 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 40 · High-performance proficiency

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 27 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 15

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-25 Air 08-20	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
25-36 Air 20-31	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
36-47 Air 31-42	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
47-65 Air 42-60	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 40

Practice high-performance proficiency. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The publisher lesson page and allocation table differ. This guide uses the lesson page: ground discussion: lesson page 42 min; allocation table 18 min. Compare the linked source pages before dispatch. The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 27 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal

landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Any high-performance/complex endorsement requires the authorized instructor's actual aircraft-specific training and proficiency finding under §61.31. A TAA session does not establish complex-airplane proficiency by itself.
- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 15 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Unusual Attitude Recovery with V.L.D. (Full & Partial Panel). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 40 - source page 65 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 41 · Complex or TAA device approaches

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min device | Brief 15 | Preflight 10 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-08 Device	[] Device setup and clearance review	Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.
08-21 Device	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
21-34 Device	[] Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction	Copy and verify the clearance, select a defensible entry, cross the fix, establish the hold, and adjust outbound timing/distance and heading for wind.
34-47 Device	[] Lateral approach and missed approach	Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or...
47-60 Device	[] ILS and approved vertical guidance	Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized...
60-73 Device	[] Failure recognition and backup control	Identify the simulated failed instrument, cross-check its reliability, establish control with valid indications, and use backup attitude/heading resources.
73-78 Device	[] Secure device and verify results	Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 41

Practice complex or taa device approaches. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Remains within the protected procedure, meets altitude/speed constraints, and corrects timing without losing control.
- Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.
- Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.
- Rejects misleading data, controls the aircraft with valid sources, and communicates the degraded capability.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Device setup and clearance review · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Verify the device configuration, intended training credit, database and weather scenario. Set failures only by the approved device method; state whether pauses are instruction or evaluation.

Student exercise: Set up the cockpit as in the aircraft, verify navigation sources, copy the starting clearance, and explain today's equipment/failure and approach plans.

Practice: One complete setup and clearance readback.

Look for: Can explain the actual simulated aircraft/equipment state before the scenario runs.

Watch / correct: Unverified setup - compare the device state with the intended aircraft/manual.

Stop / transition: Do not log unapproved credit or continue with an invalid configuration.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the learner read back and sketch the clearance, fix, course, direction, restriction, and expect-further-clearance information. Demonstrate fix-crossing flow and one entry; explain that the chosen entry must remain within protected airspace.

Student exercise: Copy and verify the clearance, select a defensible entry, cross the fix, establish the hold, and adjust outbound timing/distance and heading for wind. Communicate any inability and track clearance limits.

Practice: Two entries from different arrival directions and two complete circuits; one timed and one distance-based hold when available.

Look for: Remains within the protected procedure, meets altitude/speed constraints, and corrects timing without losing control.

Watch / correct: Entry guessed from a moving display - orient the published inbound course and aircraft arrival direction before choosing.

Watch / correct: Timing starts at the wrong place - identify the published timing convention and fix crossing.

Stop / transition: Request clarification or vectors before reaching an unclear limit; abandon exercise for unsafe control or containment.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lateral approach and missed approach · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief procedure eligibility, source, course, altitudes, MDA, missed point, visual requirements, and missed route. Demonstrate a stabilized descent using approved advisory vertical guidance only as advisory; distinguish LNAV/LP from vertically guided minima.

Student exercise: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or missed approach. At the missed point, execute the aircraft procedure, navigation sequence, and ATC report.

Practice: One complete approach and one vectored approach; at least one missed approach.

Look for: Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.

Watch / correct: Advisory glidepath treated as authorization below MDA - use the selected chart minima and required visual conditions.

Watch / correct: Early descent after a shortcut - verify the cleared segment and remaining altitude restrictions.

Stop / transition: Go missed when required by the clearance/procedure, guidance loss, unstable approach, or unmet landing conditions.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lateral approach and missed approach; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

ILS and approved vertical guidance · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Contrast ILS, LPV, and LNAV/VNAV guidance, minima, equipment requirements, and failure responses. LP provides lateral guidance only; it is not an APV. For test credit, consult current ACS conditions for the selected LPV procedure rather than labeling every LPV a precision approach.

Student exercise: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized configuration, and follow lateral/vertical guidance to the selected DA. Execute a missed approach when the required visual conditions are absent.

Practice: Two approaches with different guidance where available: one landing transition and one missed approach.

Look for: Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Watch / correct: Wrong CDI source - verify the source before intercept and compare with the chart.

Watch / correct: Below-path correction by steep descent - recover a stable path or go missed; do not chase near the ground.

Stop / transition: Go missed for lost required guidance, instability, unavailable visual conditions, or an instruction requiring it.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; ILS and approved vertical guidance; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Failure recognition and backup control · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief a realistic failure supported by the aircraft or device. Reveal its indications, require independent confirmation, then demonstrate the remaining scan. Never disable equipment that compromises the actual flight or required equipment.

Student exercise: Identify the simulated failed instrument, cross-check its reliability, establish control with valid indications, and use backup attitude/heading resources. Make timed turns and compass-supported turns with appropriate acceleration/dip error awareness.

Practice: Two different failures and one heading change each direction; device sessions may freeze only after the attempt for explanation.

Look for: Rejects misleading data, controls the aircraft with valid sources, and communicates the degraded capability.

Watch / correct: Following a failed display - cross-check independent indications and isolate the bad source.

Watch / correct: Treating compass as steady during a maneuver - stabilize before reading and use timed/backup methods as appropriate.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for loss of orientation, unsafe deviations, unavailable reliable backup, or real equipment abnormality.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Failure recognition and backup control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secure device and verify results · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Stop the scenario after a stable endpoint, review objective evidence, and distinguish simulated/device time from aircraft or airborne time.

Student exercise: Complete the simulated shutdown/checklist, describe the main error and correction, and identify the remaining practice task.

Practice: One complete scenario wrap-up.

Look for: Ends with an accurate account of what was practiced and what remains.

Watch / correct: Treating paused time as flight - record only credit permitted by the device authorization.

Stop / transition: End before fatigue makes further practice ineffective.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Instrument Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Radial Interception & Tracking. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Air Traffic Control Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Compliance with Departure, En Route, & Arrival Procedures / Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Circling Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 41 - source page 66 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 42 · Complex or TAA aircraft approaches

[Return to lesson index](#)

120 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-37 Air 08-32	[] Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction	Copy and verify the clearance, select a defensible entry, cross the fix, establish the hold, and adjust outbound timing/distance and heading for wind.
37-61 Air 32-56	[] Lateral approach and missed approach	Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or...
61-84 Air 56-79	[] ILS and approved vertical guidance	Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized...
84-107 Air 79-102	[] Failure recognition and backup control	Identify the simulated failed instrument, cross-check its reliability, establish control with valid indications, and use backup attitude/heading resources.
107-117 Air 102-112	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
117-120 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 42

Practice complex or taa aircraft approaches. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 84-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Remains within the protected procedure, meets altitude/speed constraints, and corrects timing without losing control.
- Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.
- Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.
- Rejects misleading data, controls the aircraft with valid sources, and communicates the degraded capability.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction · 24 minutes

Teach / coach: Have the learner read back and sketch the clearance, fix, course, direction, restriction, and expect-further-clearance information. Demonstrate fix-crossing flow and one entry; explain that the chosen entry must remain within protected airspace.

Student exercise: Copy and verify the clearance, select a defensible entry, cross the fix, establish the hold, and adjust outbound timing/distance and heading for wind. Communicate any inability and track clearance limits. Plan 24 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two entries from different arrival directions and two complete circuits; one timed and one distance-based hold when available.

Look for: Remains within the protected procedure, meets altitude/speed constraints, and corrects timing without losing control.

Watch / correct: Entry guessed from a moving display - orient the published inbound course and aircraft arrival direction before choosing.

Watch / correct: Timing starts at the wrong place - identify the published timing convention and fix crossing.

Stop / transition: Request clarification or vectors before reaching an unclear limit; abandon exercise for unsafe control or containment.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Clearance, holding entry, and wind correction; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lateral approach and missed approach · 24 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief procedure eligibility, source, course, altitudes, MDA, missed point, visual requirements, and missed route. Demonstrate a stabilized descent using approved advisory vertical guidance only as advisory; distinguish LNAV/LP from vertically guided minima.

Student exercise: Load or tune and identify the procedure, brief it, fly the cleared entry, meet restrictions, descend to the published MDA, and hold it until a legal landing or missed approach. At the missed point, execute the aircraft procedure, navigation sequence, and ATC report. Plan 24 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions

determine what can be logged.

Practice: One complete approach and one vectored approach; at least one missed approach.

Look for: Maintains lateral guidance and altitude restrictions, applies the correct minima, and promptly flies a missed approach when required.

Watch / correct: Advisory glidepath treated as authorization below MDA - use the selected chart minima and required visual conditions.

Watch / correct: Early descent after a shortcut - verify the cleared segment and remaining altitude restrictions.

Stop / transition: Go missed when required by the clearance/procedure, guidance loss, unstable approach, or unmet landing conditions.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lateral approach and missed approach; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

ILS and approved vertical guidance · 23 minutes

Teach / coach: Contrast ILS, LPV, and LNAV/VNAV guidance, minima, equipment requirements, and failure responses. LP provides lateral guidance only; it is not an APV. For test credit, consult current ACS conditions for the selected LPV procedure rather than labeling every LPV a precision approach.

Student exercise: Brief an ILS or approved vertically guided procedure, verify the active navigation source and annunciation, intercept as cleared, establish a stabilized configuration, and follow lateral/vertical guidance to the selected DA. Execute a missed approach when the required visual conditions are absent. Plan 23 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two approaches with different guidance where available: one landing transition and one missed approach.

Look for: Uses the correct source, minima, and annunciations, stabilizes early, and makes a timely decision at DA.

Watch / correct: Wrong CDI source - verify the source before intercept and compare with the chart.

Watch / correct: Below-path correction by steep descent - recover a stable path or go missed; do not chase near the ground.

Stop / transition: Go missed for lost required guidance, instability, unavailable visual conditions, or an instruction requiring it.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; ILS and approved vertical guidance; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Failure recognition and backup control · 23 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief a realistic failure supported by the aircraft or device. Reveal its indications, require independent confirmation, then demonstrate the remaining scan. Never disable equipment that compromises the actual flight or required equipment.

Student exercise: Identify the simulated failed instrument, cross-check its reliability, establish control with valid indications, and use backup attitude/heading resources. Make timed turns and compass-supported turns with appropriate acceleration/dip error awareness. Plan 13 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two different failures and one heading change each direction; device sessions may freeze only after the attempt for explanation.

Look for: Rejects misleading data, controls the aircraft with valid sources, and communicates the degraded capability.

Watch / correct: Following a failed display - cross-check independent indications and isolate the bad source.

Watch / correct: Treating compass as steady during a maneuver - stabilize before reading and use timed/backup methods as appropriate.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for loss of orientation, unsafe deviations, unavailable reliable backup, or real equipment abnormality.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Failure recognition and backup control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D.). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Air Traffic Control Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Compliance with Departure, En Route, & Arrival Procedures / Clearances. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Radial Interception & Tracking (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Missed Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Circling Approach Procedures. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Landing from a Straight-In or Circling Approach. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 42 - source page 67 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 43 · Complex or TAA PIC readiness

[Return to lesson index](#)

102 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-33 Air 08-28	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
33-52 Air 28-47	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
52-71 Air 47-66	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
71-89 Air 66-84	[] Recognize and recover unusual attitudes	Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation...
89-99 Air 84-94	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
99-102 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 43

Practice complex or task readiness. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 20 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the installed gear/propeller or TAA systems, limitations, checklists, engine management, and cockpit flows. Demonstrate a configuration change with positive verification, then require checklist confirmation; TAA experience alone does not create a complex-airplane endorsement.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One full configuration cycle plus two landing transitions; repeat the weakest checklist or energy-management step.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 19 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 19 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Recognize and recover unusual attitudes · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief transfer of control and the approved recovery procedure. Present modest, realistic unusual attitudes within aircraft limitations; demonstrate how reliable indications distinguish nose-high, nose-low, spiral, and failed-display situations.

Student exercise: Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation or automation confusion caused the upset. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One nose-high and one nose-low recovery; repeat using the briefed reduced instrument set if the source lesson calls for it.

Look for: Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Watch / correct: Control response before diagnosis - identify the attitude using reliable cues first.

Watch / correct: Recovery creates a secondary stall/overspeed - manage angle of attack, bank, power, and load according to the approved procedure.

Stop / transition: Instructor ends setup or takes control before aircraft limits, safety altitude, or recovery margin are threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Recognize and recover unusual attitudes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Any high-performance/complex endorsement requires the authorized instructor's actual aircraft-specific training and proficiency finding under §61.31. A TAA session does not establish complex-airplane proficiency by itself.
- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D.). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 43 - source page 68 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 44 · Stage III aircraft assessment

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min check | Brief 39 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 21

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-25 Air 08-20	[] Complex/TAA configuration and energy control	Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist.
25-37 Air 20-32	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
37-48 Air 32-43	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
48-59 Air 43-54	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
59-77 Air 54-72	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 44

Assess independent performance and decisions using current FAA criteria; pause coaching except to protect safety.

Source clarification: The publisher lesson page and allocation table differ. This guide uses the lesson page: ground discussion: lesson page 60 min; allocation table 90 min. Compare the linked source pages before dispatch. The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.
- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 39 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Assess the learner's departure, configuration, and course intercept independently; give no coaching during the check.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Complex/TAA configuration and energy control · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed complex/taa configuration and energy control scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Manage start, departure, climb, cruise, descent, and landing configurations using the approved checklist. Announce configuration and engine limits before changes, verify the result, and manage energy so the approach is stable before the landing decision.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Uses the correct aircraft procedure, verifies configuration, respects limits, and avoids rushed or ambiguous cockpit actions.

Watch / correct: Flow without verification - use the checklist to confirm actual system state.

Watch / correct: Late energy management - plan descent/configuration sooner or go around.

Stop / transition: End the simulation for a real system warning or unresolved configuration; use approved procedures and land as appropriate.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Complex/TAA configuration and energy control; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

VFR route management and diversion · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed vfr route management and diversion scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed takeoff, landing, and go-around technique scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed abnormal systems, descent, and landing options scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed build the scan and trim loop scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 21 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 44 - source page 70, 71 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Commercial maneuvers and final readiness

Build precise performance maneuvers, safe stall-risk recognition, landing judgment, and independent readiness.

Lesson 45 · Preparation: Four Forces of Flight (Lift, Drag, Weight, Thrust), Four Fundamentals of Flight (Straight & Le...

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 46 · Chandelles and steep spirals

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-26 Air 08-21	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
26-39 Air 21-34	[] Steep spiral and glide planning	Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover...
39-52 Air 34-47	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
52-65 Air 47-60	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 46

Practice chandelles and steep spirals. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Steep spiral and glide planning · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Select a suitable reference with a safe altitude margin and explain how wind changes the bank/ground track. Brief approved glide/engine-management procedures and recovery gate; keep the simulated glide from becoming an actual emergency.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover at the briefed gate on a selected heading.

Practice: One complete spiral within the available safe altitude; repeat one wind quadrant if needed.

Look for: Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.

Watch / correct: Bank increased to fix poor reference choice - choose geometry that fits safe bank and altitude limits.

Watch / correct: Airspeed neglected while watching the ground - cross-check glide performance throughout.

Stop / transition: Recover at the prebriefed gate, before excessive bank/airspeed or insufficient terrain clearance.

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Steep turns with commercial precision · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria.

Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Descent. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Aircraft Stability (Yaw). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Aircraft Stability (Pitch). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Aircraft Stability (Roll). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Falling Leaf. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 46 - source page 73 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 47 · Lazy eights and energy refinement

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-26 Air 08-21	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
26-39 Air 21-34	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
39-52 Air 34-47	[] Steep spiral and glide planning	Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover...
52-65 Air 47-60	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 47

Practice lazy eights and energy refinement. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Use ground reference directions to show the sequence and pitch/bank/airspeed trends. Demonstrate smooth control pressure and balanced segments, emphasizing anticipation rather than fixed control positions.

Student exercise: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: Two full left/right cycles; repeat the quarter where timing or coordination broke down.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Steep spiral and glide planning · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Select a suitable reference with a safe altitude margin and explain how wind changes the bank/ground track. Brief approved glide/engine-management procedures and recovery gate; keep the simulated glide from becoming an actual emergency.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover at the briefed gate on a selected heading.

Practice: One complete spiral within the available safe altitude; repeat one wind quadrant if needed.

Look for: Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.

Watch / correct: Bank increased to fix poor reference choice - choose geometry that fits safe bank and altitude limits.

Watch / correct: Airspeed neglected while watching the ground - cross-check glide performance throughout.

Stop / transition: Recover at the prebriefed gate, before excessive bank/airspeed or insufficient terrain clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep spiral and glide planning; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 13 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Descent. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Lesson 48 · Preparation: Eights on Pylons, Determining Wind Direction & Speed, Effect of Wind

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation](#); assignments on the referenced TCO pages

[FAA aviation handbooks](#); use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 49 · Pylons and accuracy landing introduction

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-31 Air 08-26	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing...
31-48 Air 26-43	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
48-65 Air 43-60	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 49

Practice pylons and accuracy landing introduction. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry.

Student exercise: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief - 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 49 - source page 76 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 50 · Performance maneuver integration

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition.
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
35-45 Air 30-40	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
45-55 Air 40-50	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing...
55-65 Air 50-60	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 50

Practice performance maneuver integration. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria.

Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Use ground reference directions to show the sequence and pitch/bank/airspeed trends.

Demonstrate smooth control pressure and balanced segments, emphasizing anticipation rather than fixed control positions.

Student exercise: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: Two full left/right cycles; repeat the quarter where timing or coordination broke down.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry.

Student exercise: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls (20° Bank). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls (20° Bank). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Aborted Takeoff. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Slips. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: No Flap Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Turbulent Air Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 50 - source page 77 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 51 · Independent maneuver and landing practice

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight...
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Independently: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish...
35-45 Air 30-40	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Independently: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
45-55 Air 40-50	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Independently: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude...
55-65 Air 50-60	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	Independently: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and...
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 51

Practice independent maneuver and landing practice. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria. Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Use ground reference directions to show the sequence and pitch/bank/airspeed trends. Demonstrate smooth control pressure and balanced segments, emphasizing anticipation rather than fixed control positions. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: Two full left/right cycles; repeat the quarter where timing or coordination broke down.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 51 - source page 78 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 52 · Preparation: Aerodynamic Forces, Gyroscopic Forces, Aircraft Certification

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 53 · Advanced stall-risk recognition

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-36 Air 08-31	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
36-59 Air 31-54	[] Secondary and configuration-related stall risk	Describe the causal chain, rehearse the correct go-around/trim response, and recover from approved simulated stall-risk scenarios.
59-77 Air 54-72	[] Recognize and recover unusual attitudes	Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation...
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 53

Practice advanced stall-risk recognition. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Recognizes the risk before control loss and prioritizes angle of attack, coordination, and approved configuration recovery.
- Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 23 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secondary and configuration-related stall risk · 23 minutes

Teach / coach: Explain how trim, distraction, go-around power, or inappropriate rudder can raise angle of attack or upset coordination. Demonstrate only aircraft-approved scenarios at a safe altitude; cross-controlled and falling-leaf source items are discussion/device substitutes when aircraft approval or risk margin is absent. Spin awareness is recognition/avoidance, not an intentional spin authorization.

Student exercise: Describe the causal chain, rehearse the correct go-around/trim response, and recover from approved simulated stall-risk scenarios. Distinguish a stall/spin risk from a diving spiral and explain prevention before another attempt.

Practice: Two selected approved risk scenarios plus a verbal spin-avoidance and spiral-recovery comparison.

Look for: Recognizes the risk before control loss and prioritizes angle of attack, coordination, and approved configuration recovery.

Watch / correct: Aggressive pull after recovery - avoid a secondary stall and stabilize before returning to altitude.

Watch / correct: Power/trim surprise on go-around - apply the approved sequence with deliberate pitch and trim control.

Stop / transition: No intentional spins or nonapproved demonstrations; terminate for yaw/roll departure or reduced recovery margin.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Secondary and configuration-related stall risk; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Recognize and recover unusual attitudes · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief transfer of control and the approved recovery procedure. Present modest, realistic unusual attitudes within aircraft limitations; demonstrate how reliable indications distinguish nose-high, nose-low, spiral, and failed-display situations.

Student exercise: Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation or automation confusion caused the upset. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One nose-high and one nose-low recovery; repeat using the briefed reduced instrument set if the source lesson calls for it.

Look for: Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Watch / correct: Control response before diagnosis - identify the attitude using reliable cues first.

Watch / correct: Recovery creates a secondary stall/overspeed - manage angle of attack, bank, power, and load according to the approved procedure.

Stop / transition: Instructor ends setup or takes control before aircraft limits, safety altitude, or recovery margin are threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Recognize and recover unusual attitudes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Stalls during Go-Around / Rejected Landing (demonstrated at a safe altitude). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 53 - source page 80 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 54 · Stall-risk recovery proficiency

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-36 Air 08-31	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
36-59 Air 31-54	[] Secondary and configuration-related stall risk	Describe the causal chain, rehearse the correct go-around/trim response, and recover from approved simulated stall-risk scenarios.
59-77 Air 54-72	[] Recognize and recover unusual attitudes	Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation...
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 54

Practice stall-risk recovery proficiency. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Recognizes the risk before control loss and prioritizes angle of attack, coordination, and approved configuration recovery.
- Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 23 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Secondary and configuration-related stall risk · 23 minutes

Teach / coach: Explain how trim, distraction, go-around power, or inappropriate rudder can raise angle of attack or upset coordination. Demonstrate only aircraft-approved scenarios at a safe altitude; cross-controlled and falling-leaf source items are discussion/device substitutes when aircraft approval or risk margin is absent. Spin awareness is recognition/avoidance, not an intentional spin authorization.

Student exercise: Describe the causal chain, rehearse the correct go-around/trim response, and recover from approved simulated stall-risk scenarios. Distinguish a stall/spin risk from a diving spiral and explain prevention before another attempt.

Practice: Two selected approved risk scenarios plus a verbal spin-avoidance and spiral-recovery comparison.

Look for: Recognizes the risk before control loss and prioritizes angle of attack, coordination, and approved configuration recovery.

Watch / correct: Aggressive pull after recovery - avoid a secondary stall and stabilize before returning to altitude.

Watch / correct: Power/trim surprise on go-around - apply the approved sequence with deliberate pitch and trim control.

Stop / transition: No intentional spins or nonapproved demonstrations; terminate for yaw/roll departure or reduced recovery margin.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Secondary and configuration-related stall risk; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Recognize and recover unusual attitudes · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief transfer of control and the approved recovery procedure. Present modest, realistic unusual attitudes within aircraft limitations; demonstrate how reliable indications distinguish nose-high, nose-low, spiral, and failed-display situations.

Student exercise: Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation or automation confusion caused the upset. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One nose-high and one nose-low recovery; repeat using the briefed reduced instrument set if the source lesson calls for it.

Look for: Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Watch / correct: Control response before diagnosis - identify the attitude using reliable cues first.

Watch / correct: Recovery creates a secondary stall/overspeed - manage angle of attack, bank, power, and load according to the approved procedure.

Stop / transition: Instructor ends setup or takes control before aircraft limits, safety altitude, or recovery margin are threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Recognize and recover unusual attitudes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Stalls during Go-Around / Rejected Landing (demonstrated at a safe altitude). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 54 - source page 81 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 55 · Precision and stall-risk review

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-25 Air 08-20	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition.
25-36 Air 20-31	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
36-47 Air 31-42	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
47-65 Air 42-60	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 55

Practice precision and stall-risk review. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria.

Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Lazy Eights. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Emergency Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Secondary Stall. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Elevator Trim Stall. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Aborted Takeoff. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Unusual Attitude Recovery with V.L.D. (Full & Partial Panel). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 55 - source page 82 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 56 · Ground references and landing refinement

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-25 Air 08-20	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing...
25-36 Air 20-31	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
36-47 Air 31-42	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
47-65 Air 42-60	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 56

Practice ground references and landing refinement. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 12 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry.

Student exercise: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Chandelles. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Lazy Eights. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Secondary Stall. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Elevator Trim Stall. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Unusual Attitude Recovery with V.L.D. (Full & Partial Panel. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 56 - source page 83 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 57 · Preparation: Commercial Pilot Privileges & Limitations, Basic Aerodynamics, Recognition of Critical Weather...

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 58 · Integrated commercial review

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
35-45 Air 30-40	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing...
45-55 Air 40-50	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
55-65 Air 50-60	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 58

Practice integrated commercial review. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Use ground reference directions to show the sequence and pitch/bank/airspeed trends. Demonstrate smooth control pressure and balanced segments, emphasizing anticipation rather than fixed control positions.

Student exercise: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: Two full left/right cycles; repeat the quarter where timing or coordination broke down.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry.

Student exercise: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 58 - source page 85 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 59 · Independent commercial rehearsal

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight...
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Independently: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish...
35-45 Air 30-40	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Independently: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
45-55 Air 40-50	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Independently: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude...
55-65 Air 50-60	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	Independently: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and...
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 59

Practice independent commercial rehearsal. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria. Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Use ground reference directions to show the sequence and pitch/bank/airspeed trends. Demonstrate smooth control pressure and balanced segments, emphasizing anticipation rather than fixed control positions. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: Two full left/right cycles; repeat the quarter where timing or coordination broke down.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 59 - source page 86 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 60 · Correction of integrated flight errors

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition.
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
35-45 Air 30-40	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
45-55 Air 40-50	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing...
55-65 Air 50-60	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 60

Practice correction of integrated flight errors. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria.

Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions.

Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry.

Student exercise: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Chandelles. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Lazy Eights. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 60 - source page 87 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 61 · VFR route and diversion consolidation

[Return to lesson index](#)

108 min dual | Brief 20 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-31 Air 08-26	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
31-61 Air 26-56	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
61-78 Air 56-73	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
78-95 Air 73-90	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
95-105 Air 90-100	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
105-108 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 61

Practice vfr route and diversion consolidation. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 30-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Source clarification: The lesson heading prints Stage II; the course section/sequence places this lesson in Stage IV. Navigation uses the surrounding course section.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 20 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Review the learner's route, weather, terrain, fuel, performance, airspace, and alternates. In dual lessons demonstrate one prediction-check-correction cycle; later introduce a diversion or lost-position scenario without removing safe navigation options.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: Two independent checkpoints, one diversion calculation, and one landing at an appropriately selected destination.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 30 minutes

Teach / coach: Start with a stable attitude and power setting. Demonstrate attitude change, cross-check of performance, small correction, then trim. Explain which indication confirms each change; let the learner verbalize the scan before removing prompts.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 30 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with

the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: Two level-offs in each direction and at least two left/right turns; repeat the weakest transition.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 17 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.

- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: ATC Light Gun Signals. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: VOR Navigation (if equipped). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: GPS Navigation. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 61 - source page 88 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 62 · Preparation: Pilot Qualifications, Airworthiness Requirements, National Airspace System

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 63 · Independent precision consolidation

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight...
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Independently: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish...
35-45 Air 30-40	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Independently: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
45-55 Air 40-50	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Independently: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude...
55-65 Air 50-60	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	Independently: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and...
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 63

Practice independent precision consolidation. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria. Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Use ground reference directions to show the sequence and pitch/bank/airspeed trends. Demonstrate smooth control pressure and balanced segments, emphasizing anticipation rather than fixed control positions. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: Two full left/right cycles; repeat the quarter where timing or coordination broke down.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 63 - source page 90 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 64 · Independent landing and maneuver refinement

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min pic | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Steep spiral and glide planning	Independently: Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain...
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Independently: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
35-45 Air 30-40	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Independently: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude...
45-55 Air 40-50	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	Independently: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and...
55-65 Air 50-60	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 64

Practice independent landing and maneuver refinement. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.
- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMS, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch the instructor reviews the planned route, practice boundaries and return gates; no instructor is carried on a solo flight. For certificated PIC, agree on the actual pilot roles and logging eligibility.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. On the ground confirm that the pilot can execute it independently.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep spiral and glide planning · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Select a suitable reference with a safe altitude margin and explain how wind changes the bank/ground track. Brief approved glide/engine-management procedures and recovery gate; keep the simulated glide from becoming an actual emergency. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover at the briefed gate on a selected heading.

Practice: One complete spiral within the available safe altitude; repeat one wind quadrant if needed.

Look for: Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.

Watch / correct: Bank increased to fix poor reference choice - choose geometry that fits safe bank and altitude limits.

Watch / correct: Airspeed neglected while watching the ground - cross-check glide performance throughout.

Stop / transition: Recover at the prebriefed gate, before excessive bank/airspeed or insufficient terrain clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep spiral and glide planning; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Before dispatch review the approved practice plan and safety gates. Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends. For solo/PIC exercises, complete the explanation or demonstration on the ground or a preceding dual flight; there is no in-flight instructor coaching planned.

Student exercise: Independently: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Review the return decision on the ground and arrange an overdue plan.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Chandelles. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Lazy Eights. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 64 - source page 91 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 65 · Instructor-guided readiness corrections

[Return to lesson index](#)

78 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
35-45 Air 30-40	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
45-55 Air 40-50	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
55-65 Air 50-60	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
65-75 Air 60-70	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
75-78 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 65

Practice instructor-guided readiness corrections. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Use ground reference directions to show the sequence and pitch/bank/airspeed trends. Demonstrate smooth control pressure and balanced segments, emphasizing anticipation rather than fixed control positions.

Student exercise: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: Two full left/right cycles; repeat the quarter where timing or coordination broke down.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief approved configuration, clearing, entry, cues, and recovery priorities. Contrast slow flight with an intentional stall exercise and show how bank/load and coordination change the risk; do not use a source task list as authority for prohibited aircraft maneuvers.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One slow-flight sequence and one power-off/power-on pair; accelerated-stall work only when approved and briefed.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief • 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Turns. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 65 - source page 92 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 66 · Airport technique and abnormal decisions

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-29 Air 08-24	[] Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique	Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing.
29-44 Air 24-39	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
44-59 Air 39-54	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
59-77 Air 54-72	[] Recognize and recover unusual attitudes	Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation...
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 66

Practice airport technique and abnormal decisions. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique · 16 minutes

Teach / coach: Select normal, short, or soft-field work from today's source tasks and actual runway suitability. Review POH configuration/speeds, performance, touchdown plan, and go-around gates. Demonstrate one selected technique, then coach observation of approach/energy trends.

Student exercise: Fly the selected takeoff technique, climb/configure as approved, then set up the matching stabilized approach and landing. State the go-around decision before conditions deteriorate; include a normal landing to compare energy management.

Practice: Three selected patterns if traffic permits: normal, one specialty technique, and one go-around; defer remaining variations rather than rush.

Look for: Meets applicable commercial ACS criteria during evaluation and consistently recognizes an unstable or unsuitable landing.

Watch / correct: Technique memorized without performance calculation - tie the procedure to actual runway, weight, and conditions.

Watch / correct: Touchdown target rescued with abrupt control - go around and analyze the energy trend.

Stop / transition: Go around for instability, runway/traffic conflict, or loss of a safe landing path; use approved aircraft procedures.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Takeoff, landing, and go-around technique; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 15 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Recognize and recover unusual attitudes · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief transfer of control and the approved recovery procedure. Present modest, realistic unusual attitudes within aircraft limitations; demonstrate how reliable indications distinguish nose-high, nose-low, spiral, and failed-display situations.

Student exercise: Diagnose the attitude from reliable indications, use the aircraft-appropriate recovery priorities, stabilize attitude/power/airspeed, and explain how fixation or automation confusion caused the upset. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One nose-high and one nose-low recovery; repeat using the briefed reduced instrument set if the source lesson calls for it.

Look for: Recognizes the condition, promptly reduces the immediate risk, avoids secondary loss of control, and re-establishes a useful scan.

Watch / correct: Control response before diagnosis - identify the attitude using reliable cues first.

Watch / correct: Recovery creates a secondary stall/overspeed - manage angle of attack, bank, power, and load according to the approved procedure.

Stop / transition: Instructor ends setup or takes control before aircraft limits, safety altitude, or recovery margin are threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Recognize and recover unusual attitudes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.

- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Basic Attitude Instrument Flight (with V.L.D.). Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 66 - source page 93 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 67 · Preparation: Pilot Qualifications, Commercial Pilot Privileges & Limitations, Airworthiness Requirements

Prepare the knowledge and cockpit decisions needed for the next flight. Use the source pages and corresponding course assignment before meeting the instructor.

[Return to lesson index](#)

Ground preparation objectives

- Explain the source preparation topics and identify their application to the next flight.
- Bring unresolved questions and aircraft-specific differences to the briefing.

Preparation

- Use the corresponding current course ground lesson and referenced source pages.

[Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages](#)

[FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too](#)

Complete the corresponding ground lesson and bring questions to the flight briefing. This page is a preparation pointer; the flight teaching guides begin at flight lessons.

Lesson 67a · Independent readiness assessment

[Return to lesson index](#)

108 min check | Brief 58 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 32

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-23 Air 08-18	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
23-32 Air 18-27	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition.
32-41 Air 27-36	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
41-50 Air 36-45	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
50-59 Air 45-54	[] Steep spiral and glide planning	Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover...
59-68 Air 54-63	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing...
68-77 Air 63-72	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
77-86 Air 72-81	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
86-95 Air 81-90	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
95-105 Air 90-100	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
105-108 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 67a

Assess independent performance and decisions using current FAA criteria; pause coaching except to protect safety.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 58 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Assess the learner's departure, configuration, and course intercept independently; give no coaching during the check.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed vfr route management and diversion scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Steep turns with commercial precision · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed steep turns with commercial precision scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Steep spiral and glide planning · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed steep spiral and glide planning scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover at the briefed gate on a selected heading.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.

Watch / correct: Bank increased to fix poor reference choice - choose geometry that fits safe bank and altitude limits.

Watch / correct: Airspeed neglected while watching the ground - cross-check glide performance throughout.

Stop / transition: Recover at the prebriefed gate, before excessive bank/airspeed or insufficient terrain clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep spiral and glide planning; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed slow flight and stall recognition/recovery scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed power-off accuracy landing decisions scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 9 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed abnormal systems, descent, and landing options scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 32 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Physiological Aspects of Night Flying. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 67a - source page 95, 96 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 68 · Final proficiency review

[Return to lesson index](#)

90 min dual | Brief 15 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 10

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-24 Air 08-19	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition.
24-35 Air 19-30	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
35-46 Air 30-41	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
46-57 Air 41-52	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing...
57-67 Air 52-62	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
67-77 Air 62-72	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
77-87 Air 72-82	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
87-90 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 68

Practice final proficiency review. Move from explanation and demonstration to an independent attempt, with time reserved for a useful correction.

Source clarification: The publisher lesson page and allocation table differ. This guide uses the lesson page: dual flight: lesson page 90 min; allocation table 0 min; ground discussion: lesson page 18 min; allocation table 120 min. Compare the linked source pages before dispatch.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 15 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.
- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Monitor actual conditions and model a concise post-takeoff configuration flow.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Steep turns with commercial precision · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief attitude, bank/load relationship, entry/exit, clearing, and the current ACS criteria.

Demonstrate a smooth entry and coordinated correction; identify whether an altitude trend is caused by pitch, power, or bank before coaching the fix.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One left/right pair plus one targeted repeat.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Sketch the maneuver's changing bank/pitch/airspeed relationships. Demonstrate one direction, narrating the transition from the first half to the second and the coordinated rollout; use aircraft-approved entry parameters.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One each direction plus one repeat focused on the first/second-half transition.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Use ground reference directions to show the sequence and pitch/bank/airspeed trends.

Demonstrate smooth control pressure and balanced segments, emphasizing anticipation rather than fixed control positions.

Student exercise: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: Two full left/right cycles; repeat the quarter where timing or coordination broke down.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 11 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the relationship among groundspeed, pivotal altitude, wind, suitable pylons, and safe terrain clearance. Demonstrate one pylon turn, explaining why pitch rather than rudder is used to maintain the sight line; use current FAA/aircraft guidance for entry.

Student exercise: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: Two complete eights; repeat the downwind/upwind transition with the largest sight-line error.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the selected landing exercise, touchdown area, wind, runway, approved configurations, and go-around gates. Demonstrate energy judgment and allowable slips/configuration changes. Separate the commercial ACS power-off 180 task from optional 90/360-degree source exercises.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: Two power-off 180 attempts if suitable; 90/360-degree planning rehearsed on the ground or added only with time, approval, and a safe traffic plan.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: State the simulation method, instructor takeover gates, and any prohibited control actions. Teach aviate, diagnose, appropriate immediate actions, approved checklist, communication, and landing choice. Practice recognition and judgment without creating the actual failure.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One systems problem and one descent/forced-landing decision; one checklist recovery after the first response.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 10 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.
- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Steep Spiral. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Maneuvering during Slow Flight. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-Off Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Power-On Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Accelerated Stalls. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 68 - source page 97 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard

Lesson 69 · End-of-course assessment

[Return to lesson index](#)

108 min check | Brief 58 | Preflight 15 | Debrief 32

Publisher lesson target; SUAREZ.CFI phase allocation is recommended. Brief/debrief are separate from flight.

Minutes are pacing targets. Stop, repeat, or carry forward when safety or proficiency requires. Set aircraft values from POH/AFM.

Cockpit sequence

Flight / air	Exercise	Action
00-05 Ground	[] Start, taxi, and departure checks	Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before...
05-13 Air 00-08	[] Takeoff, climb, and intercept	Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course.
13-21 Air 08-16	[] VFR route management and diversion	Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time.
21-28 Air 16-23	[] Steep turns with commercial precision	Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition.
28-35 Air 23-30	[] Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade	Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at...
35-42 Air 30-37	[] Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes	Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points.
42-49 Air 37-44	[] Steep spiral and glide planning	Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover...
49-56 Air 44-51	[] Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness	Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing...
56-63 Air 51-58	[] Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery	Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover.
63-70 Air 58-65	[] Power-off accuracy landing decisions	From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the...
70-77 Air 65-72	[] Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options	Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable...
77-95 Air 72-90	[] Build the scan and trim loop	Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents.
95-105 Air 90-100	[] Return, landing, and go-around decision	Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved...
105-108 Ground	[] Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks	Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Flight = complete movement sequence. Air = minutes from takeoff; ground rows do not advance the airborne clock. Device rows create no airborne time.

Teach lesson 69

Assess independent performance and decisions using current FAA criteria; pause coaching except to protect safety.

Source clarification: The published 18-minute instrument subset is allocated within named instrument exercise blocks and is included in the flight total, not added to it.

Aircraft-neutral: set speeds, configurations, limitations, approved simulation methods, and any endorsement conditions from the actual aircraft and current rules.

Objectives

- Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.
- Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.
- Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.
- Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.
- Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.
- Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.
- Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.
- Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.
- Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.
- Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Before the flight

- Complete the corresponding ground preparation and review the referenced source pages.
- Before aircraft flight: confirm weather/NOTAMs, route/airspace, weight/balance, performance, aircraft airworthiness, personal readiness, and stop/go-around gates.
- Before simulated instrument work: agree who maintains outside lookout and how control transfer and view-limiting-device removal work.

Briefing · 58 minutes

- Agree on the named exercise priorities, aircraft-specific procedures, stop/takeover gates, weather/fuel/route limits, and how remaining source tasks will be carried forward.

- Learner explains the initial plan and one credible failure/alternate decision. Instructor corrects misunderstanding before departure.

Start, taxi, and departure checks · 5 minutes

Teach / coach: Coach checklist discipline and runway verification; during checks observe independently and intervene only for safety.

Student exercise: Start and taxi using the approved checklist, review hotspots, read back restrictions, hold short correctly, and complete run-up/departure checks before entering the runway.

Practice: One complete ground departure flow.

Look for: Positive runway/clearance verification, deliberate checklist and configuration checks.

Watch / correct: Heads-down taxi - stop before configuring or troubleshooting.

Stop / transition: Stop taxi for uncertain clearance, traffic, or an unresolved abnormality.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Takeoff, climb, and intercept · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Brief the approved takeoff/abort and climb procedure. Assess the learner's departure, configuration, and course intercept independently; give no coaching during the check.

Student exercise: Verify runway and clearance, take off using the approved technique, establish climb, configure/check, and intercept the cleared or planned course. A view-limiting device is used only after the outside-lookout/control arrangement is established.

Practice: One departure and course intercept.

Look for: Maintains control, follows the route/clearance, and completes checks at an appropriate workload.

Watch / correct: Fixation on route programming - stabilize flight and defer the entry.

Stop / transition: Abort or return under the actual aircraft procedure and conditions; no universal return altitude.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

VFR route management and diversion · 8 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed vfr route management and diversion scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Depart on the planned course, identify checkpoints, compare groundspeed/fuel with estimates, and update arrival time. Navigate to a selected alternate, use ATC services when useful, and explain the lost-position recovery plan before continuing.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Keeps an accurate position/fuel picture and revises the plan before uncertainty becomes an emergency.

Watch / correct: Only looking at the moving map - cross-check terrain, chart, course, and fuel.

Watch / correct: Late diversion calculation - use a quick heading/time/fuel estimate first, refine after control is stable.

Stop / transition: Return, land, or divert when actual conditions exceed the briefed limits; do not continue merely to complete a planned distance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; VFR route management and diversion; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Steep turns with commercial precision · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed steep turns with commercial precision scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the approved entry, fly a steep turn in each direction, anticipate rollout, and return to the starting flight condition. Describe and correct the first attempt's dominant error on the repeat.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Divides attention outside and inside, manages load/energy, and meets current ACS criteria on the independent attempt.

Watch / correct: Bank drift masked by pitch correction - correct bank and reassess altitude.

Watch / correct: Late rollout - anticipate the exit and return smoothly to straight-and-level.

Stop / transition: Recover before envelope, clearance, or altitude margin is threatened.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep turns with commercial precision; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Clear the area, enter at approved parameters, establish the climbing turn, manage the changing pitch and bank through the maneuver, and finish coordinated at the required heading and low-airspeed condition without a stall.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Uses a continuous coordinated energy trade and achieves the current ACS completion condition without abrupt corrections.

Watch / correct: Pitch/bank schedule rushed - identify the transition points and let airspeed trend develop.

Watch / correct: Yaw near completion - prioritize coordination as airspeed decreases.

Stop / transition: Recover immediately for stall cues, loss of coordination, or inadequate altitude/clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Clear the area and fly linked left/right segments through the maneuver's reference points. Observe the changing attitude/airspeed, coordinate the turns, and compare the second half with the first before repeating.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Maintains a smooth continuous maneuver, balanced segments, and current ACS criteria with useful outside references.

Watch / correct: Maneuver becomes two abrupt turns - smooth the control changes across reference points.

Watch / correct: Reference fixation - distribute attention among horizon, references, coordination, and performance.

Stop / transition: Stop for stall cues, disorientation, or a threatened aircraft/safety limit.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Steep spiral and glide planning · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed steep spiral and glide planning scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Clear the area, establish the appropriate glide configuration and speed, turn around the reference with wind-adjusted bank, maintain coordination, and recover at the briefed gate on a selected heading.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Maintains glide and reference spacing while respecting bank/load and recovery margins.

Watch / correct: Bank increased to fix poor reference choice - choose geometry that fits safe bank and altitude limits.

Watch / correct: Airspeed neglected while watching the ground - cross-check glide performance throughout.

Stop / transition: Recover at the prebriefed gate, before excessive bank/airspeed or insufficient terrain clearance.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Steep spiral and glide planning; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Select safe pylons, determine an appropriate entry and pivotal-altitude estimate, clear the area, and fly linked turns while adjusting altitude for changing groundspeed. Maintain coordination and abandon unsuitable geometry.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Keeps the pylon on the selected sight line using appropriate pitch changes without unsafe bank or clearance loss.

Watch / correct: Rudder used to hold the pylon - restore coordination and adjust pitch/altitude appropriately.

Watch / correct: Pylons chosen too close or hazardous - discontinue and select a safe pair.

Stop / transition: Exit when terrain/obstacles, bank, coordination, or aircraft limits cannot be maintained.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed slow flight and stall recognition/recovery scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Establish the assigned slow-flight condition, make coordinated turns/climbs/descents, and recover. Conduct approved power-off/power-on stall exercises in the requested attitudes, recognize cues, reduce angle of attack, and restore a controlled flight path.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Recognizes cues early, manages coordination, and recovers without excessive altitude loss or secondary stall.

Watch / correct: Holding altitude after stall warning - reduce angle of attack and follow the approved recovery.

Watch / correct: Yaw during entry - correct coordination or terminate before loss of control.

Stop / transition: Recover for unbriefed yaw, roll, envelope exceedance, altitude-margin loss, or an aircraft restriction.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Power-off accuracy landing decisions · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed power-off accuracy landing decisions scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: From the agreed position reduce power using the approved simulation, assess glide/wind, choose turn points and configuration deliberately, and aim for the selected touchdown area. Go around when a safe outcome is doubtful rather than forcing the target.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Uses a consistent glide picture and current ACS criteria on evaluation while preserving a safe runway landing or go-around.

Watch / correct: Stretching glide with pitch - preserve the approved glide condition and change the landing plan.

Watch / correct: Late flap/slip correction near touchdown - improve the earlier energy decision or go around.

Stop / transition: Go around for unstable geometry, unsafe bank, traffic, or insufficient runway; do not force the touchdown mark.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Power-off accuracy landing decisions; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options · 7 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed abnormal systems, descent, and landing options scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Identify a simulated abnormality from valid indications, control the aircraft, apply aircraft-approved actions, use the checklist, and select a suitable landing/alternate. For a simulated forced landing, establish the approved glide profile and plan a reachable field; terminate at the briefed gate.

Practice: One selected assessed/review attempt within this short block. Full teaching or remaining repetitions must be carried forward; do not rush the task.

Look for: Maintains control, avoids premature diagnosis, and chooses a landing plan supported by terrain, wind, and aircraft capability.

Watch / correct: Checklist before control - stabilize and manage the immediate hazard first.

Watch / correct: Field selected without reachability - compare glide/terrain/wind and choose a viable alternative early.

Stop / transition: Recover at the briefed safety gate; never shut down critical equipment or engines solely to imitate an emergency.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Build the scan and trim loop · 18 minutes

Teach / coach: Assign the briefed build the scan and trim loop scenario and observe setup, execution, and decisions without coaching. Assess this result: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage. Record errors for the parked debrief; intervene immediately for safety. New instruction and corrective demonstration belong in a separate training flight.

Student exercise: Establish straight-and-level flight, make assigned standard-rate turns, then constant-airspeed climbs and descents. Lead the level-off, set cruise power, verify performance, and trim without abandoning the cross-check. Plan 18 minutes of this block as actual or simulated instrument only with the agreed legal pilot/instructor/lookout arrangement; actual conditions determine what can be logged.

Practice: One independent demonstration of each selected task; remedial coaching belongs in a later training flight.

Look for: Maintains an effective cross-check and corrects trends before large deviations; uses applicable ACS tolerances at the evaluation stage.

Watch / correct: Fixation on one instrument - identify the missing cross-check and return to attitude/performance confirmation.

Watch / correct: Large chase corrections - stabilize attitude and power, wait for the response, then refine.

Stop / transition: Remove the view-limiting device or take control for unsafe trends, traffic conflict, disorientation, or an unrecoverable task load.

Reference: FAA Airplane Flying Handbook; Build the scan and trim loop; current ACS and applicable POH/AFM

Return, landing, and go-around decision · 10 minutes

Teach / coach: Reassess fuel, weather, traffic, runway and learner workload before returning. Let the learner plan the arrival; avoid rescuing a late approach with last-minute prompts.

Student exercise: Obtain the arrival information/clearance, brief the runway and landing configuration, fly a stabilized approach, land if safe or go around using the approved procedure, then clear the runway.

Practice: One stable arrival and final landing; additional approaches are only those budgeted in exercise blocks.

Look for: Timely configuration and a decisive landing/go-around choice.

Watch / correct: Late arrival briefing - finish the plan before descent or request delay.

Stop / transition: Go around whenever the safe landing conditions are not met.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Taxi in, shutdown, and aircraft checks · 3 minutes

Teach / coach: Keep the learner focused on taxi and securing the airplane; gather teaching notes after movement stops.

Student exercise: Clear and identify the taxi route, perform after-landing checks when safe, park, shut down, secure, and report any equipment discrepancy.

Practice: One complete shutdown and securing flow.

Look for: Safe taxi and accurate checklist/equipment follow-up.

Watch / correct: Debrief during a hotspot - postpone discussion until parked.

Stop / transition: Stop for uncertain route or traffic; complete abnormal follow-up before another departure.

Reference: Applicable POH/AFM and checklist; FAA Airplane Flying Handbook

Completion criteria

- Maintains aircraft control, checklist/clearance discipline, and safe decisions throughout the complete session.
- Demonstrates the selected objectives at today's expected level: coached learning during introduction, fewer cues during review, and current ACS criteria independently at checks.
- Unmet or unobserved source tasks are identified for a later flight; elapsed time and checkmarks are not a proficiency endorsement.

Debrief · 32 minutes

- Learner names the strongest result and the first decision/control error.

- Instructor ties one observed error to its cause, gives a specific correction, and confirms the next practice priority.
- Compare actual exercise/route time with this plan and verify any regulatory experience credit independently.

Repeat or carry forward

- The source lists more tasks than can receive full teaching and multiple repetitions in this target. Today's named exercise blocks are the priority; select additional reviews from the source only when time and proficiency permit, and carry unmet tasks forward.
- VFR route management and diversion: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Steep turns with commercial precision: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Chandelles: coordinated climbing energy trade: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Lazy eights: visual references and smooth energy changes: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Steep spiral and glide planning: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Eights on pylons and pivotal-altitude awareness: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Slow flight and stall recognition/recovery: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Power-off accuracy landing decisions: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Abnormal systems, descent, and landing options: only a selected attempt fits this block. Schedule a dedicated repeat if the task is new or proficiency is not demonstrated.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Physiological Aspects of Night Flying. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Preflight Inspection/ Assessment. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Soft-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Takeoff & Climb. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Short-Field Approach & Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Go-Around / Rejected Landing. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Eights on Pylons. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.
- Source task for another focused block if not observed today: Spin Awareness. Select the applicable FAA/aircraft procedure and schedule adequate instruction; no completion is implied by this checklist.

Study and sources

Corresponding Sporty's course preparation; assignments on the referenced TCO pages

FAA aviation handbooks; use aircraft/equipment supplements too

Sporty's Academy Commercial TCO - lesson 69 - source page 99, 100 - Sporty's Academy Commercial 141 TCO V17 / 06-17-2026

FAA ACS criteria and evaluator instructions - source page Relevant areas of operation - Current FAA linked standard